

Acres

written by

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EXT. CREEKSIDE - DAY

Close up shot

A WORM wriggles aside a fishing HOOK with RUSSELL (15yr boy, 1862 birth year) dirty hands struggling to harpoon the side.

ALICIA (V.O)
Why is it always fishing? Ugh.
Mind traveling can be so boring
sometimes.

ABIGAIL (O.S.)
It's squirming. It's not supposed
to do that.

EXT. CREEKSIDE - CONTINUOUS

RUSSELL
Stay still little fella. This ain't
going to to kill you the fish will.

ABIGAIL (V.O.)
Would you stay still if I tried to
harpoon you.

WIDE ANGLE: Russell holds the hooked worm like a trophy as he grabs the converted stick, a fishing rod.

RUSSELL
Why would you harpoon me?

ANGLE ON: ABIGAIL (14yrs, girl, 1862 birth year) sitting under a REED built shelter surrounded by dirt.

ABIGAIL
You've given more reasons than I
can count.

RUSSELL
That's not really high.

Russell places the rod down and walks towards Abigail.

RUSSELL (CONT'D)
One. Two. Three. When you're out of
fingers. Dad! Dad!

Russell plots himself down under the shelter. He nudges Abigail over for space. She pushes back, then presses herself up off the ground and AWAY from the shelter.

ALICIA (V.O.)
You got this Abigail.

POV: Abigail brushes dirt off her hands.

ANGLE ON: Russell intently watches Abigail make the way to pick up the rod. He JUDGES her stance, gait, and preparation.

RUSSELL
Don't catch the trees. We ain't got
any extra string. Put it left of
the rocks or it'll get caught.

ABIGAIL
How bout I put it right ...
(pause)
Into your mouth. I'm better at this
than you.

ALICIA (V.O.)
Because fishing is where you two
have the best arguments that
entertain me.

Abigail casts the line.

CLOSE ON: The worm twirls in the air then FALLS towards the water. Splash!

ANGLE ON: Abigail spins a 540 as the worm sinks behind into the CREEK. She moseys back to the shelter. Her hand swooshes Russell to the side as she sits under the shelter.

IMAGE: 'Ruzzel' is carved into the dirt. A nail punch in a small TIN CAN is aside the words.

ANGLE DOWN: Abigail glances down towards her brother who is leaning low and staring out at the fishing rod.

ABIGAIL
Do you know how to spell you name?

RUSSELL
(frustrated)
I know I can't find my pocketknife.
I know I'm hungry.

ABIGAIL
(shocked)
You ate twice morning.

RUSSELL

Eggs don't fill me up because I got to get them from the hens in the morning.

ABIGAIL

Stop thinking about food. There are more important things - like clothes. I thought about wearing my Sunday best a day early.

Russell shakes his head as Abigail highlights her topic.

ABIGAIL (CONT'D)

I'd wear my blue ruffle dress; white lace down the arms with flowers on the underside. Flip my palms over and see a garden from elbow to wrist, sunflowers, daisies and roses. I'd wear a corset.

ALICIA (V.O.)

Croissant?

RACHEL (V.O.)

Alicia!

LOW RUMBLE of THUNDER.

CLOSE ON: Russell turns his head to stare at the gray sky.

RUSSELL

Was that thunder?

ABIGAIL

(solemnly)

Great. Ten minutes to walk home.

(sigh)

I'm gonna get all muddy.

ANGLE UP: Russell glances to his sister as RAIN PELTS his face and speckles the dirt. Lightning CRACKS!

RUSSELL

Nothing takes that long to get muddy. I could muddy that blue dress in under a minute.

ABIGAIL

Why would you be in my dress?

RACHEL (V.O.)

ALICIA!

CUT TO BLACK.

EXT. TREEHOUSE - DAY

ANGLE DOWN: A late for dinner RACHEL (late 30s, wife, mother of three) glances up at the LARGE TREEHOUSE where her only daughter ALICIA (14yrs, girl) is laying on the Treehouse DECK.

RACHEL

You're late for dinner. Everyone's waiting.

ALICIA

I'm coming down.

Alicia rolls to her side to leave the treehouse.

RACHEL

Make it quick!

(scanning the yard)

Daughter? Why does my yard look like a gofer field?

ANGLE ON: Alicia DISMOUNTS the treehouse steps. She puts a POCKETKNIFE into her pocket. She smiles at Rachel as the two walk towards the house. A WILLOW TREE and REMNANTS of STONE FARMHOUSE on the right. A garden on the left with two scarecrows in BLUE overalls and one scarecrow in PINK overalls.

RACHEL (CONT'D)

Are you going to answer my question?

ALICIA

Maybe yes... Probably not today.

RACHEL

So what were you digging today?
Treasure? Fossils?

TRACKING SHOT: Alicia and Rachel walking past the FARMHOUSE with an open ORCHARD in the background. One patch of grass is not mowed.

ALICIA

None of the above. Just fishing at the creek with Russell and-

RACHEL

Whose Russell? If you have boys over, then I should probably know.

ALICIA

No one you know. Doubt I'll see him again till he washes up. His nails were hid-e-ous. He hadn't cleaned them in decades which is saying something because he's my age.

A patch of yard was MISSED by the mower.

RACHEL

(looking aside to Alicia)
The maestro of the mower missed more spots than you dug up.

ALICIA

Hey (pausing) You're right let's focus on him.
(silently)
Not me.

ANGLE ON: KYLE (late 30s, male, husband) holds open the sliding door to the LARGE WOOD DECK on the TWO-STORY HOUSE. Rachel catches his eye as her and Alicia walk onto the deck.

KYLE

Ready for dinner?

RACHEL

What happened to the maestro of mowing? Got more spots in the grass than a Dalmatian.

Kyle turns to speak into the house.

KYLE

Boys! Cruella has arrived?

ALICIA (V.O.)

Oh my God!

Alicia grabs a watering can and scurries away from the unfolding catastrophe. She heads toward the shed on the deck.

CLOSE ON: The shed doors open to see Alicia staring into the shed.

ALICIA

Putting this away.

ALICIA (V.O.)
Do not look back at the carnage.
Everything has a place. This looks
like a good place for this thing.

She places the watering can in the saw location. Turning towards the sliding doors, Rachel enters the house as Kyle releases the stress with an exhale. Alicia walks towards and under his arm.

ALICIA
You survived. Bit surprised.

KYLE
Go wash your hands. I'm going to
work on digging my grave. I'll be
needing it soon.

CUT TO:

INT. AVERYS DINNING ROOM - CONTINUOUS

ANGLE ON: Alicia walks through the dining room into the hall. Kyle closes the door then sits with his sons at the table of summer FRUIT, RABBIT FOOD and a giant TURKEY. MASON (15yrs, boy) fills his mouth with a fork of chicken while his brother PATRICK (10yrs, boy) reloads his spoon with a pea.

KYLE
(glaring at Mason)
We wait for everyone to sit before
starting.

MASON
(mumbling)
I need more food.

Patrick flings a pea into his brother's forehead.

PATRICK
You need manners.

Kyle SMILES as Rachel sets the can shaped CRANBERRY SAUCE.

KYLE
Patrick. Truce. Mason. I can't
believe you're mine.

RACHEL
I can.

Patrick surveys the table to gather a feel of situation. He sees MIXED emotions on faces.

PATRICK
I want chicken nuggets!

RACHEL
(curtly)
No! We have one sit down dinner a
week. Try to be civil. Alicia!

CUT TO:

INT. AVERYS BATHROOM - CONTINUOUS

CLOSE ON: Alicia is WASHING her hands.

ANGLE ON: Alicia dries her hands on a SUMMER TOWEL and
relaxes as she FAKES a smile in the mirror. A last exhale,
she turns and exits to the hall then enters the dining room.

CUT TO:

INT. AVERYS DINNING ROOM - MOMENTS LATER

Close On: Rabbit food. Wiggling cranberry sauce. A perfect
TURKEY. Alicia takes her seat.

PATRICK
How was the dig?

ALICIA
Fun. You should try it. Go outside.

PATRICK
I thought about it, then I thought
about video games. Wasn't much of a
competition.

MASON
Is it ever a competition?

PATRICK
If electricity's out, batteries are
dead and I have no other options,
then it's a tie.

KYLE
Alright. You know the drill.

RACHEL
Kyle! Kids ...
(scanning table)
Bow your heads and a moment of
silence.

The table falls silent. Everyone less Alicia bow their heads. Alicia corners her eye on Kyle.

ALICIA (V.O.)
Dad. You always break first then
wait for mom. Predictable as the
sunrise.

Kyle breaks his hands and eyes lift to see Rachel. He pauses for the rest of the minute. Rachel ends her prayer.

RACHEL
Amen!

ALICIA
(without hesitation)
Dad. I love you, but if you were a
wild animal, I think you'd be
extinct.

Shock fills the face. Alicia smiles, reaches over and grab a spoonful of CRANBERRY. She fills her plate first.

ALICIA (V.O.)
Victory! Alicia says go!

Rachel fills her plate. Kyle doubles his mashed potato. Mason passes the RABBIT FOOD while watching Patrick precisely place each strawberry to make a mosaic in his food.

RACHEL
Hey, Bob Ross. It's food not a
landscape.

PATRICK
(placing a broccoli
upright)
Happy little trees.

Rachel smirks at the humor she needed.

RACHEL
Can we finish without a brawl
breaking out this week. Last weeks'
food fight was unnecessary,
unreasonable and took two baths to
get the honey out of Mason's hair.

MASON
I still have a bald spot on the
right side.

PATRICK
Looks like an improvement to me.

Patrick watches his broccoli trees FALL to the plate. The family begins to enjoy the meal.

CUT TO:

INT. AVERYS UPSTAIRS HALLWAY - EVENING

LOW ANGLE: Mason fires a Missile at an annoyed Alicia. Patrick takes a Nerf missile to his leg.

CUT TO:

INT. AVERYS ALICIA BEDROOM - CONTINUOUS

Alicia's room (light blue 12 x 14 with a closet). She examines her closet which is organized by color and style. She places her shirt in the proper place. A glance to the window, then a few steps towards the BAOBOB TREE painted onto the wall with small WOOD SHELVES adorned with bracelets, trinkets, and pennies. She places the pocketknife onto a ledge.

ALICIA
Everything has a place. Now-

Alicia steps LEFT to take in her floor to ceiling BOOKCASE. She scans her way past: History to Mystery: A telling adventure; Five Bridges to Nowhere; Animal Farm. She pulls out a book Clothes and Style.

CLOSE ON: Thumbing through the appendix

ALICIA (O.S.) (CONT'D)
A. B. C. Cape, Cashmere, Capri,
Corset. Page 47.
(thumbs to page)
Ag, Abigail didn't wear a
croissant, it was a corset. Be
kinda silly to Wear a pastry.

She places the book back, walks to her bed, and falls into her bed. As she glances at the ceiling...

ALICIA (CONT'D)
Only one and a half days of school
left then freedom.

Alicia turns to her nightstand to turn the light off.

CUT TO BLACK.

INT. SCHOOL BUS - MORNING

Alicia sits aside Celenia (13 yrs, girl, Puerto Rican). The bus is crowded.

CELENIA

Did you see the sign still out?

ALICIA

Been out all year. Figure they'd care about that.

CELENIA

Nope.

(glancing up the aisle)

Guess which bus?

ALICIA

Forty-three?

WIDE SHOT: Legs dangle in the aisle as the back of BUS 21 is in the distance. Celenia pulls her BACKPACK (Puerto Rico flag and AMERICANA memorabilia) onto her lap.

CELENIA

Nope 21. Forty-three was yesterday. Speaking of yesterday, I finished my report. 15 pages of single-spaced details.

ALICIA

Ms. Caripol isn't going to expect that. Mine is only five. There wasn't much on the American Civil War. Well, there was, but I wasn't interested.

MRS CLARKE (V.O.)

Stay seated.

ANGLE ON: The students partially rise as MR. WOLIVER. (50s, male, gray hair) enters the bus to speak with MRS. CLARKE (30s, female). Patrick is eavesdropping from Seat 1. A moment passes as everyone waits. Mr. Woliver leaves.

MRS CLARKE

Everyone have a great day.

Everyone waits then BERNEY (13 yrs, Soccer fanatic) bolts down the row and out the door.

WIDE SHOT: from bus as Berney's joins the pack of students walking past the teachers who stand guard SMILING at the entrance.

INTO VIEW: the Backpacks rise as kids disembark from the bus. One then two then a traffic jam.

CUT TO:

EXT. ROSSMOYNE MIDDLE BUS LANE - MORNING

Celenia and Alicia exit the bus and start to mingle forward into the wave of students. MARIANNE (13 yrs, girl) joins Celenia as they wander forward. The entrance is protected by TOWERING TEACHERS (taller than average adults) As Alicia makes her way forward towards the doors.

ALICIA (V.O.)

I can't tell if everyone is happy, sad or barely awake. Teachers look happy. They all have a 10 on the face - a smile that doesn't leave room for anything else. Three months off will do that for you. Except Ms. Rotz- She's got a 7 smile. She's coming back to teach Summer school. Ha, if I don't pass the Math final I may up there this year.

ANGLE UP: Alicia passes the Towering Teachers and enters the school.

CUT TO:

INT. ROSSMOYNE MIDDLE SCHOOL HALL - CONTINUOUS

Alicia follows Marianne and Celenia to the right. They pass Barney who has a 2 staring up at Mr. Wolaver who is lecturing the young man.

ALICIA (V.O.)

Hmm. Barney's got a 2. Oh, he's starting to frown. I hope he doesn't hit a 1 and cry.

Alicia narrowly misses running into a locker. A sigh of relief then off towards her 1st class. The HALLWAY is clean, windows clear. It's a normal JUNE day of school.

CUT TO:

INT. ROSSMOYNE SCHOOL HISTORY - MOMENTS LATER

History class with US posters. Desks five rows deep with four across. Large DESK for MS. CARIPOL (20s, teacher).

Alicia passes the front table. A trifold board (Teddy and Franklin Roosevelt) is flanked by the GINGER twins Matt and Melanie.

ALICIA (V.O.)
Overachievers.

PAN VIEW: The front row has four students.

ALICIA (V.O.) (CONT'D)
Everyone in row one has an 8 or 7 smile. Can't sleep or fake paying attention in row one. It's why I don't sit there in row one.

Alicia takes her seat in ROW 2, COLUMN 4, behind ERIC (13yrs, boy, husky). She leans forward and to her left BRIANA (13yrs, girl) stares at Matt with a 6. Celenia is organizing papers in her seat (ROW 2, COLUMN 1).

ALICIA (V.O.) (CONT'D)
Briana. Stop staring at Matt.
(exhales)
Celenia is ready.

Image: Squirrels playing in the trees OUTSIDE the classroom.

ANGLE ON: Ms. Caripol stands at her desk at the back. She lets the last few students sit.

MS. CARIPOL
I've got the order on the board.
It will be tough but we'll try to get through everyone today. First presenters are ready.

WIDE ON: Matt and Melanie nod ready to the other.

MELANIE
Our report is on two presidents. I have Franklin Roosevelt and Matt has Theodore Roosevelt.

MATT
They were cousins. Teddy was born in 1858 in New York City. I'll touch on his early life, the Rough Riders, and a Bull Moose Hybrid.

CAMERA PANS: ROW ONE faces show 7 and 8. ROW TWO has Celenia with a 4 and Briana at an 9. ROW THREE has HENRY (13yrs, boy) doodling and MARISA (13 yrs, girl) with a 5. ROW FOUR is empty. ROW FIVE has CHAD (14 yrs, boy) head down and frantically writing, jostling papers.

CUT TO:

INT. ROSSMOYNE SCHOOL HISTORY - MOMENTS LATER

MELANIE

Quick wrap up - Teddy and FDR are cousin-president guys. Eleanor Roosevelt, she's the sleeper that you want to remember. That's our presentation. Any questions?

(glancing for raised hands)

None. Great. Thanks.

CLAPPING from the STUDENTS.

MS. CARIPOL

Good job you two erase your names then take you seats.

Matt erases his and Melanie's name from spot 1 of list. Remaining 8 sets of names with Michael/Davis at 6. Carla/Jackson at 7. Alicia/Celenia at 8. Chad/Jeremiah at 9. Matt walks towards the SEATED students to return to his seat.

CUT TO:

INT. ROSSMOYNE SCHOOL HISTORY - MOMENTS LATER

CLOSE ON: 1 to 5 NAMES erased on the list.

Michael anxiously paces at the FRONT PODIUM. He turns the lights off as the BLINDS are DOWN.

CLOSE ON: Michael glances at the blue screen on the computer. He glances up towards Ms. Caripol at her DESK.

MS. CARIPOL

Need any help Michael?

MICHAEL

No. Just wishing Clark was here.

CLOSE ON: Ms. Caripol marks F for Davis on her grade sheet.

ANGLE ON: The projector shows Lewis and Clark: A Journey to the Sea and Back. Michael anxiously waits for PERMISSION to start. Ms. Caripol nods to Michael to begin. Her eye catches Chad frantically writing his report.

CLOSE ON: Ms. Caripol writes SUMMER SCHOOL next to CHAD on the grade sheet.

ANGLE ON: Alicia in the foreground staring at Michael who starts his presentation.

ALICIA (V.O.)
Wonder who is going to take a nap.

MICHAEL
Alright. Ah. My presentation is
Lewis and Clark. I had Lewis.
Clark isn't here so-

MS. CARIPOL
-Just do your best. It's all you
can ever do.

ALICIA (V.O.)
Stretching it Ms. Caripol.

Alicia glances right as Briana fades to 3. She witnesses other students falling asleep.

ANGLE ON: Michael is talking as slides change of the LEWIS AND CLARK EXPEDITION. Michael is stuck at slide 'Time for Clark' on the screen. He looks to Ms. Caripol for SALVATION.

MS. CARIPOL
Skip to the end.

Michael fast fords to the last screen titled 'Questions.'

MICHAEL
Questions? About Louis, not Clark.

Chad raises his hand.

CHAD
Did Clarke make it back first?

A collective eye roll from those still awake. Michael hands wave up in frustration.

MICHAEL
If you want him to...sure. Why not?

MS. CARIPOL
Flick the lights on. Then back to
your seat.

Michael turns the light on and beelines to his seat. Alicia and Celenia rise in unison; each step and setup is planned to perfection. Ms. Caripol scans the damage - students asleep, dazed.

At Center Stage, Alicia and Celenia show confidence. No trifold or PowerPoint. The clock ticks as they wait for Ms. Caripol to finish lecturing Chad. Ms. Caripol nods.

MS. CARIPOL (CONT'D)
You can start.

CELENIA
My great-grandfather is Jose Miguel
Luis Rodriguez. Born in San Juan,
Puerto Rico.

ALICIA
My great-grandfather is Brian
O'Connell. Born in Mahoney,
Pennsylvania.

CELENIA
Jose moved to the City of Brotherly
when he was fifteen.

ALICIA
That's Philadelphia. Brian lived in
Mahoney his entire life.

CELENIA
That's Appalachia Coal area.
You'll learn about that in a bit.
I'll take over from here for three
minutes and forty- five seconds.

INTO VIEW: Ms. Caripol smirks.

CLOSE ON: A check MARK for preparedness, articulation,
cooperation.

Close on: A Purple Heart in a glass case.

CELENIA (CONT'D)
I'll close by passing around This
heart. Great-grandfather got it
when a plane hit the Navy ship he
was on. Walked with a lean left
everyday after.

CELENIA gives ground to Alicia.

ALICIA

Brian always wanted to be called Brain. He was the guy who told jokes at funerals and laughed at working twice as hard for half the pay digging coal.

ANGLE ON (OTS): Alicia keeps talking as students pay attention with 6, 8, and a lone 10 from Michael.

ALICIA (CONT'D)

Mom said she remembers Brain always sitting at the corner of the church on Sundays. He didn't have a fancy title or anything, just like watching the birds.

CELENIA AND ALICIA (CONT'D)

That's all we got folks. If you'll return the Purple Heart and bits of anthracite coal, we will wrap it up from here.

CLOSE ON: CLOCK reads 9:53.

ANGLE ON: Ms. Caripol rises from her seat and makes her way to the front.

MS. CARIPOL

Great job class. As you can see, you all started with the same assignment. Select a pair. And you each ended with a different type of pairs: athlete, presidents, family. Unfortunately, we don't have enough time so Chad and Jeremy will have to wait till tomorrow.

EVERYONE hears Chad celebrate. An impossible 11 GLOWS from Chad.

ALICIA (V.O.)

Not fair! Get that 11 off your face. You didn't ...

MS. CARIPOL

However,

(Pause)

(MORE)

MS. CARIPOL (CONT'D)
To be fair all reports still due
today.

BAM! Chad's head hits the desk.

ALICIA (V.O.)
Haha. Your smile just went to zero!

Ms. Carpool dismisses class a few minutes early. The kids
walk out of class. Alicia and Celenia wait to be last out.

CUT TO:

INT. ROSSMOYNE SCHOOL ENGLISH - MOMENTS LATER:

CLOSE ON: English Test Question 37: Select the sentence that
effectively utilizes the words affect and effect in the
proper tense.

ALICIA (V.O.)
I hate homonyms. I'd rather be
outside.

ANGEL ON: MS. BONAWITZ (30s female, pretty) sits on her phone
scrolling up. She looks at the clock. 12:43 changes to 12:55.

CLOSE ON (OTS): Alicia stares at Question 37

ALICIA (V.O.) (CONT'D)
Wonder if dad has to do bubble
tests at work. Probably has two
sheets a month and promotions are
based on test results.

ANGLE ON: Ms. Bonawitz glances at her NEW WATCH.

MS. BONAWITZ
Five minutes.

PAN ON: All students rush to finish.

ALICIA (V.O.)
Hopefully I get points for bubble
design.

CLOSE ON: Alicia's sheet shows all C except 37 an A. Bell
rings. The students rise from their seats. Except Carl (14
years old, slacker). Alicia glances at him as she exits the
aisle.

ALICIA (V.O.) (CONT'D)
Surprise you showed up. You already
have Summer school for three
different classes.

Alicia exits the room as the SECOND to LAST STUDENT.

CUT TO BLACK.

EXT. ROSSMOYNE COURTYARD - AFTERNOON

Alicia and Michael sit on a bench. Students finish moving dirt and pick up clippings. Chad holds the bag as MR. YEAGER (50s, history teacher) glares at MARK (13 yrs, skater boy) examining a DANDELION.

MR. YEAGER
Mark. You're embarrassing our
species and my class. What are you
doing?

MARK
It's the last lion in the
courtyard.

Close on: Mark stares at a dandelion.

MR. YEAGER
It's a weed not a lion. Chad!

MARK
No.
(turns towards Chad)
You killed its family. Cross the
rake and we'll have trouble.

ALICIA
I won't save you Mark.

MICHAEL
I'll save you Mark

ALICIA
Are you strong enough to pull him
back from the ledge. I've seen you
throw a baseball.

MR. YEAGER
Chad the lion-slayer.

MICHAEL
It'd be close, but close counts.

ALICIA
I'm going to Georgia. If I'm only
close, I could end up in Virginia.

CHAD walks towards the dandelion.

CLOSE ON: Chad's foot steps over the rake.

ANGLE ON: Alicia and Michael stare at Mark and Chad
maneuvering around one another. It appears to be a tie.

ALICIA (CONT'D)
You going to the game Mike?

MICHAEL
Yeah, I'm pulling for the
Athletics.

ALICIA
Makes sense since Dodgers crushed
you.

Chad jives past Mark who falls to the ground. A quick pull
and the dandelion is DEAD. Mr. Yeager whistles everyone to
go.

MR. YEAGER
Final class. Everyone exit left. If
you want to see the dead lion, exit
right. Ignore the crying child.

Mark bags his lion as Chad winces in pain.

WIDE ON: The students exit the area with Mark crying on the
ground and Mr. Yeager shaking his head in disgust.

CUT TO:

EXT. BALL FIELD CONCESSION STAND - EVENING

Alicia and Marianne stand second in line at the CONCESSION
STAND. Glancing at the menu of food, candy, Slush Puppies).
Stepping up to the counter with MICHELLE (baseball mom).

MICHELLE
Evening ladies. What can I get
you?

MARIANNE
Slush Puppy and potential brain
freeze.

ALICIA

Make it two without the pain.

Michelle turns to see the chaos of pizza smoke burning.

MICHELLE

All flavors have a bit of smoke.
Same as last game?

ALICIA

How do you even remember that?

MICHELLE

I saw you curl up in a ball on the
ground from the last freeze. I
swear I didn't laugh... too much.

MARIANNE

I did and I'll do it again. Peach
for me

ALICIA

Blueberry times two.

CLOSE ON: Alicia places money on the bar. Michelle gets the drinks. Marianne looks and sees Michael attempt, fail at catching a tennis ball.

ANGLE ON: Michael sprints towards the wall as other GUYS try to get the ball. The girls grab their drink, no change.

ANGLE ON: Alicia and Marianne make their way away from the stand and they see CHRIS (13 yrs, boys) side arm the tennis ball into the wall. The ball bounces into Michael who falls to the ground. Michael face slides down the wall.

TRACKING SHOT: Alicia and Marianne walk towards the bleachers aside the field as the ROYALS (blue uniforms, Mason) are on the field. PIRATES (yellow and black uniforms) on third base line.

ALICIA (CONT'D)

Looks like Mason is pitching. He
was practicing at home with dad.

MARIANNE

Yeah, I heard him scream.

ALICIA

Dad almost broke Mason's hand and
separated his shoulder.

MARIANNE

It happens.

TRACKING SHOT: Alicia and Marianne make their way behind the BLEACHERS. Rachel sits on top seat with Patrick gaming aside her.

RACHEL

Patrick. What do you say to your sister?

Patrick ignores the world.

RACHEL (CONT'D)

Patrick.

Rachel nudges her son. He notices the world. Alicia incoherently tells Patrick his flavor and details.

RACHEL (CONT'D)

You're going go blind staring at that thing

Patrick takes his drink. Alicia and Marianne take their SEATS (lawn chairs). Alicia takes in the view (right fence line, center dangling legs from the bleachers, left is the backstop fence.

UMPIRE (V.O.)

Strike Three!

MARIANNE

Sounds like something important just happened. If only I cared about it.

ALICIA

Don't stress. Only thing we are catching is some shut-eye. Wake me up when it's over.

MARIANNE

You ever giving Michael back his had.

ALICIA

Maybe. Not certain yet.

Alicia and Marianne relax, sip there drinks for the game. Alicia's tips Michaels cap down over her eyes.

ALICIA (CONT'D)

I love baseball. I get sleep and Patrick will tell me who won.

CUT TO BLACK.

EXT. BALL FIELD OUTFIELD - AFTERNOON

WIDE ON: DODGERS are warming up tossing the ball on the sidelines.

ANGLE ON: A ball fades into the sun then out.

ALICIA (V.O.)
(screaming)
Why did you throw a ball into the
sun? I can't catch. Neither can
Michael.

Michael uses his LOUISVILLE MITT to pick up the ball. He looks at MATT (13yrs, Royals), holds his toss, glances at the opposing team Dodgers (blue/white uniforms). Michael tosses to Matt,

MATT
Be nice if you get on first so I
can knock you in.

MICHAEL
Definitely better than a strike out
which I'm pretty good at.

MATT
Gotta lead the team in something.

As he tosses the ball towards Michael.

STAN (V.O.)
Rally Up!

Players start to come huddle around STAN (40s, male).
Michael, nearly last in, see Stan POP UP like a prairie dog.

STAN
Chris no lollygagging. Matt I don't
know what you're doing but stop.
Michael. Game will be over before
you get here.

ALICIA (V.O.)
Ask Stan if you won? Come on it'd
be funny. You know I'm right.
Well, I know I'm right.

CLOSE ON: Royals in huddle with Stan.

STAN
We need this win so I'll keep this
short. One win and we get another
game. One loss we're out.
(MORE)

STAN (CONT'D)

Focus on execution, excitement and winning. On the count of three. One! Two! Three!

ROYALS AND ALICIA (V.O.)

Let's go team!

Royals make their way towards the dugout. As ALAN (12 yrs, small) leads to batters box with DUSTIN (13yrs, tall) in runner-up box. The rest enter the dugout out.

ALAN

Big game fellas! Let's keep it up.
Let's mercy rule these fools.
Woohoo!

ALICIA (V.O.)

Hahaha. Go Alan!

Chris moves by Michael who takes his seat on the bench. The dugout is gearing up for the first pitch. Derek (13 yrs, lefty) grabs SUNFLOWER SEEDS from his bag.

DEREK

Anyone want some seeds? Going once.
Twice.

CHRIS

What flavor?

DEREK

Mix of Bar-b-que, Ranch and unflavored

ALICIA (V.O.)

Unflavored isn't going to be unflavored in a bag of flavored. Think it through boys.

CHRIS AND MICHAEL

Yes.

CLOSE ON: Derek pours seeds into Chris's cup.

ANGLE UP. Michael stares out as Alan hug the plate. Ball 1 is too high. Derek pours seed into Michael's palm. Michael moves them around and tosses them into his mouth. Alan resets for the next pitch.

DEREK

Let's go Alan!

Michael stares at the pitch. Pop! Alan gets hit with the ball. The players collectively AWE.

Stan jogs in for the save. Michael STANDS then SITS back down the seeds moving in his hand.

CLOSE ON: The seeds appear to melt through Michael's hands.

ALICIA (V.O.)
Why are the seeds melting in your
hand? Eww. That's disgusting and
certainly not normal.

THUNDER CRACKS

CUT TO BLACK.

EXT. BALL FIELD - BLEACHERS - EVENING

CLOSE ON: Alicia JOLTS up from her chair to see LIGHTNING.
RAIN FALLS. She checks the field - empty; bleachers - empty.
A turn BEHIND is Marianne struggling with her CHAIR and
running away. BOOM! CRACK!

ALICIA
Some friend you are!

Alicia tosses her chair and sprints towards Marianne.

MARIANNE
Every woman for herself. You move
it or you loose it.

Alicia passes Marianne. Marianne give up on the chair.

MARIANNE (CON'T) (CONT'D)
Forget this!

CRACK! BOOM! The FRIGHTENED two run towards the van. They
dodge parking curbs, cars, and a TEEN (15yrs) playing in the
rain. The van door opens as Alicia then Marianne jump into
the van.

CUT TO:

INT. BALL FIELD - VAN - CONTINUOUS

Alicia and Marianne are drenched from the rain. Patrick in
the front passenger seat is a bit wet. Rachel is dry as the
desert. Patrick leans back to his sister, holding out an
imaginary towel.

PATRICK
Your soaking wet. Towel?

Close On: Alicia grabs at nothing. SHOCKED are the two girls!

PATRICK (CONT'D)
Or no towel? That is the question.

ALICIA
Real question is can mom trade you
for Marianne?

MARIANNE
My parents wouldn't take that deal.

ALICIA
I can toss in my allowance.

RACHEL
I will consider that if Patrick
doesn't give you the towels that I
gave him.
(glancing at her son)
Do it again and you can go play in
the rain like the crazy kid

IMAGE ON: Teen (15yrs) playing in the rain as Alicia and
Marianne glare out the foggy van WINDOWS.

RACHEL (CONT'D)
Keep an eye out for dad. He's been
helping everyone get to safety.

ALICIA
(shocked)
He didn't help me.

RACHEL
You told me not to wake you. I
complied.

FADE TO BLACK:

EXT. AVERYS - DRIVE WAY - EVENING

CLOSE ON: Kyle is peaking at the HAIL that is bouncing off
the van. An impatient Rachel and Mason BOLT out the doors.
Alicia, Marianne and Patrick wait.

ANGLE ON: Mason celebrates first to the door. The door is
LOCKED. RACHEL fails to pull the keys out of her GREEN SUEDE
PURSE which falls in a puddle. Rachel FINALLY opens the door
and they BURST INSIDE.

CUT TO:

INT. AVERYS - DRIVE WAY - CONTINUOUS

ANGLE ON (OTS): Kyle glances back at Alicia, Marianne and Patrick.

KYLE
Sometimes it's good to be first.
Don't tell you mom that this isn't
one of those time. Called it.

PATRICK
(to Marianne)
I hope the morgue has an opening.

Kyle leaves. Patrick, Marianne and Alicia follow behind to get inside.

CUT TO:

INT. AVERYS - KITCHEN - CONTINUOUS

CLOSE ON: GREEN SUEDE PURSE pours water into the sink.

ANGLE ON: Rachel sets the PURSE on the countertop LEDGE, frowns as she hears from behind a sneaking KYLE.

RACHEL
Look at my purse! Best purse I got
in five years ruined.

KYLE
It can make it.

CLOSE ON: The purse falls in on itself then into the trash.

CLOSE ON: Kyle EXHALES the stress of the situation.

KYLE (CONT'D)
Maybe a minor catastrophe. Scale of
ten, I'd say three.

RACHEL
Three. That's a fifty dollar purse.

ANGLE ON: Kyle withdraws at the sound of the price.

RACHEL (CONT'D)
Figuring out tomorrow is a 10 on my
scale. We can't both be preparing
for the party and at the game. You
have to coach and be at 3rd base.

Kyle grabs an APPLE to give him something to move around.

KYLE

No one was expecting the game to be cancelled. Harvey said he'd play them to the fourth inning to prevent the make-up game. Kinda got the impression if a Tornado touched down, he'd say play ball!

(pausing for smile)

That should've cracked a smile. If you can get Mason to the field, I'll get him home.

RACHEL

I get two. You get one.

KYLE

(flexing)

I've got the heavy lifting. Why I got these?

RACHEL

Ha. Didn't work in college. Heck,

Rachel pauses at Mason in ZOMBIE form. He sits down, then wanders up to lean and mope around the kitchen.

KYLE

You gonna talk or just mumble?

MASON

(frustrated)

It was barely lightning. I wasn't holding a metal bat. I think it's a conspiracy to make me lose the game.

RACHEL

You're not old enough to have a conspiracy theory. Got to be eighteen first. Ask Ricky, he'll tell you at his birthday.

KYLE

We can win the game tomorrow. I'll get you home while mom sets the party. Now, I don't like the undead in my kitchen so go shower.
(glancing at Rachel)

Do we have everything for Ricky's party?

RACHEL

We've got everything until the last minute when we remember what we forgot.

ANGLE ON: Rachel watches Mason leave while Alicia and Marianne DRESS (Raincoats, Boots) for camping out. Rachel brightens her SMILE.

RACHEL (CONT'D)

You continuing the tradition in this weather? Could stay inside?

ALICIA

No. We packed before the game. We've got more Smores than we can eat. But we'll try to eat them all.

MARIANNE

I've got enough bug spray to cause a mass extinction. Plus, we've got nothing else to do tonight or tomorrow. Might as well do nothing outside.

Kyle rises to proclaim his knowledge.

KYLE

I believe, and your mother can correct if I'm wrong, that you still have a half day of school tomorrow. One more day to wake up early and ride the yellow school bus.

A DEATH glare from the girls towards Kyle.

RACHEL

You two can go out when it clears. Shouldn't be too long. Dad and I'll be watching a movie in the living room.

(turning to Kyle)

You get the tea. I'll get the pillow.

Rachel exits the kitchen. Alicia and Marianne sigh at their BOREDOM and waiting. Kyle pours some tea.

CUT TO BLACK.

EXT. AVERYS - ACRES - NIGHT

WIDE ON: Orange and Yellow HELMET LIGHTS spin in the dark. A flash of the garden, willow, farmhouse, grass, and a giant TREEHOUSE (8' x 20', ladders, cargo net, two single tents). Alicia and Marianne focus their lights on the treehouse, then each other, then turn to Kyle who is hauling two LARGE DUFFLE BAGS.

ALICIA

Keep up dad! I'm using the ladder.

MARIANNE

I got the bottom.

Marianne puts PRESSURE on the bottom of the CARGO LADDER. ANGLE DOWN: Alicia stares up through the opening in the landing. Hand over hand Alicia reaches, rolls onto the landing to see the NIGHT SKY.

MARIANNE (O.S.) (CONT'D)

Hell-o! Your light keeps moving up there. Is it clear?

EXT. AVERYS - ACRES TREEHOUSE - NIGHT

ANGLE UP: Alicia gives a thumbs up. Marianne starts her way up the ladder. She struggles as the ladder SWAYS.

MARIANNE

Mr...

(scanning the acres)

Where's your dad? It's hard to climb up without someone at the bottom.

ALICIA

He was right behind us.

(looking down to Marianne)

How do I lose a dad? Wonder if mom will be mad. Maybe she'll get a new one.

KYLE

I heard that.

ANGLE ON (OTS) Alicia turns to see a lite up ORANGE Kyle walking up the stairs. He dumps out the duffle bag on the landing then looks over the items.

KYLE (CONT'D)

Let's see what you ladies are packing for the night. Anything I need to be concerned about?

ALICIA

No! And I don't like you sneaking up like that! Why do you do that?

KYLE

Because I'm a dad and I built the stairs.

MARIANNE (V.O.)

Hello! Sounds like a good talk up there. Love to be a part of it.

CLOSE ON: Marianne dangles in the net. She glances up to SEE Alicia's come into view.

MARIANNE

A real friend would lend a hand.

ALICIA

I don't have any hands to spare, but I can hold the rope.

ANGLE ON: Marianne joins Alicia on the landing.

MARIANNE

I need a vacation. To a place with only elevators. No ladders. Mr. Averys can you build an elevator for this place.

(pausing to CRICKETS)

Mr. Averys?

Kyle is making his way down the stairs and towards the house.

MARIANNE (CON'T) (CONT'D)

Elevator!

KYLE

(walking away)

Can't get a permit for it. Couldn't get a permit to kill the giant spiders and cat-sized ticks! You ladies have fun out here. I'll be in bed.

ALICIA

No such thing as giant spiders or rat-sized ticks.

MARIANNE

Yeah, I am not falling for that.
I'll get the food inside the tent
in case it rains or I need a snack.

Marianne fills her hands with COOKIES, DRINK, and a BOOK.
Alicia pulls a duffle bag to her TENT.

MARIANNE (CONT'D)

Want to review the reserves?

ALICIA

We did that inside.
(seeing Marianne yawn)
We've been here three minutes and
you're already yawning. The
tradition isn't falling asleep as
soon as we get up to the landing.
We've got to stay awake for a few
hours.

MARIANNE

Too many rules. Did you remember
the list?

Alicia shuffles through the duffle bag. NOTHING! She tries
with the SECOND duffle bag, places it over herself.

ALICIA

No luck in here.

CLOSE ON: Marianne QUICKLY taps the DUFFLE BAG. She laughs as
Alicia tosses it from her head. Marianne holds up the list.

MARIANNE

List was in my pocket.
(confidently)
Item 1. Gossip. We did that inside.

ALICIA

Been doing that since I was born.

MARIANNE

Item 2. Explore graveyard.
(pause)
Item 3. Meteor Shower. Item 4.
Sleep. Maybe we skip the graveyard,
I don't want to ruin my boots.

ALICIA

They're boots. They won't get
ruined. They're made to get dirty.
(MORE)

ALICIA (CONT'D)

I don't think you can handle the dark. May the giant spiders scare you? Do they scare you?

MARIANNE

I'm Marianne Day. What do you think? Besides, the screen saver on the tablet is a burning yule log and animals are afraid of fire.

ANGLE ON: Alicia smiles a 10 and nods her head in amusement.

ALICIA

I don't think that's how it works. But if we get chased by a bear, you hold up that yule log high and proud. I'll just keep running.

EXT. AVERYS - ACRES TREEHOUSE - LATE NIGHT

WIDE ON: The two settle into their respective TENTS. Marianne covers with MOSQUITO netting, excessive BUG SPRAY. Marianne is swiping her tablet to get to BOOK.

ALICIA

Where are you at in the book?

MARIANNE

Page thirty of three hundred and two. It's the part where Greeley just made it back to sector Halo.

ALICIA

I remember that. If you want I can spoil the last two hundred plus pages for you. It'll save you time. There are other books I'd recommend. Perhaps the dictionary would be more beneficial for you.

MARIANNE

(glaring)

Perhaps when you fall asleep, I'll take the markers and draw a cheetah print across your forehead. Imagine going to school with that on your face. Actually, it might be an improvement for some people. Timmy Davis would benefit from an animal print. Then again, he'd benefit from a transplant.

ALICIA

I doubt your aunt would like that.
He's right on the other side of the
creek. We can holler for him if you
want?

MARIANNE

Nope. He's in bed by eight. He does
the early bird gets the worm thing.

ALICIA

Ugg. I prefer the sleep in thing.
Wish we could do that tonight.

Alicia and Marianne get comfortable on the uncomfortable
landing.

ALICIA (CONT'D)

Snow make up days are unbearable. I
don't like going in. It's worse
than a week of detention.

MARIANNE

Haha. Brings back bad memories. I
set the alarm for half an hour.
Figure we could doze off a bit.

CLOSE ON: Marianne turns the tablet AROUND to display a YULE
LOG.

ALICIA

Set a second alarm just in case. We
got lucky the rain ended by 7:30.
The clouds cleared up quickly after
that.

MARIANNE

Let me know if you need anything.
That way I can enjoy saying 'no.'

Marianne turns her light out. Alicia SETTLES in and PULLS a
folder from the landing to herself.

CLOSE ON: ALICIA opens the folder to display a plastic bound
old LETTER. She lays down on the bench, rolls to her side and
moves her fingers onto the letter.

ALICIA (V.O.)

Time to close my eyes and get
comfortable.

FADE TO BLACK:

INT - FARMHOUSE - GREAT ROOM - SUNSET

BANG! The windows RATTLE!

FADE IN: 1863 STONE FARMHOUSE (3 rooms, Great, Bedroom, Kitchen). An old DESK is aside a FIREPLACE. The decor is MENNONITE. ALICE (20s, female) is WRITING (ink, quill) on the desk.

ALICE
(warily)
Writing is most done Howard.

ALICIA (V.O.)
I think you want to be anyplace but
here. Maybe a homestead out West.

ALICE
(whispers)
God left this place so men can
march here.
(loudly)
Never wrote such a legal letter.

HOWARD (late 20s, husky) is dressed in UNION BLUES. He is struggling with his BOOT.

HOWARD
Alice. I didn't ever write a letter
till I met you. Just spark the fire
and cast the iron. I love seeing
you enjoy the writing desk. It was
my present to you on our wedding
day.

ALICE
Do you think we'll have another?

Howard's doesn't answer. He smiles at a SUCCESSFUL boot.
BANG! The windows RATTLE! Alice stands, holds the LETTER in
her hand.

ALICE (CONT'D)
Why'd they got to do it here? Why'd
you have to go?

HOWARD
They do it here because they have
to. I go because it is our land.

ALICIA (V.O.)
It does help with tourism in my
time.

HOWARD
Lincoln asked to fight.

ALICIA (V.O.)
Lincoln! I know that name was going
to come up!

ANGLE ON: Alice kneels to FINISH the second BOOT. Howard
stands with pride and presents himself.

ALICE
You're going to war looking like a
blueberry.

ALICIA (V.O.)
Haha. So true Alice.

ALICE
I don't want dead bodies or crosses
on our front step, back steps or
within a days walk. Our fields are
green in Gettysburg. They shouldn't
turn red.

BANG! The windows RATTLE! Silence as they WATCH one another
wander for something, anything. Alice EXHALES her stress.

ALICE (CONT'D)
If you don't put suspenders on your
pants will fall down and show
everyone your britches.

HOWARD
I'm hoping they ain't close enough.

Alice shakes her head as she walks towards the BEDROOM (Large
single room, 3 small beds).

Knock! Knock! Knock!

ALICIA (V.O.)
Door!

FRONT IMAGE: Door. Alice brings SUSPENDERS from the room. She
goes to Howard. Knock! Alice helps Howard finish his dress.

Knock! Knock! Knock!

ALICIA (V.O.) (CONT'D)
Turn right! I know you can't hear
me or do what I say. Someone is
knocking. Behind door one. It's a
bird. It's a plane. Are you going
to get it?

Alice slowly walks to the door. She grabs the handle. Pauses.
Knock! Knock! Knock! BANG! The windows RATTLE!

HOWARD (O.S.)
You going to get that Alice.

ALICE
(mumbling)
Please be my sister.

CLOSE ON: Alice swings open the door.

INTO VIEW: CORPORAL DAVIS (30s, union blue, ragged) and
CORPORAL AVERYS (20s, union blue, ragged) stand on the FRONT
STEP. The men tip their hats. Corporal Davis silently
introduces Corporal Averys and talks. Alice FAKES a smile and
stares past the men. The SETTING SUN passes through TREES to
Silhouette a line of MARCHING MEN (union troops). The MARCH
of the men from left to right as seasoned soldiers.

ALICIA (V.O.)
He's asking for your name Alice.

CORPORAL DAVIS
Your name maam.

ALICE
A-Alice.

CORPORAL DAVIS
Pardon us Alice. I am Corporal
Davis of the I-Corps. Under orders
of Major General John Reynolds, we
will request to use this land as a
way station.

HAROLD (O.S.)
You got it!

ALICE
As my husband said. You're welcome
to this land and homestead.

ANGLE ON (OTS): Alice greets the men to enter the farmhouse.
Corporal Davis and Corporal Averys enter the home. BANG! The
windows RATTLE! Howard SALUTES the visitors.

HOWARD
Howard Campbell. Private.
Pennsylvania militia.

CORPORAL DAVIS
I'm Corporal Davis. This is
Corporal Averys.

ALICIA (V.O.)
That's my name!

CORPORAL DAVIS
Our troops will mostly just pass through and by the land for the next two days. Can't say we won't ask for the house to help the wounded.

ALICE
You use the house for what you need. Howard would volunteer it anyway. Just as he did himself.

Corporals glance at the FIREPLACE PAINTING (orchards).

HOWARD
Alice painted our orchard. Best apples in the county. If your men need it-

CORPORAL DAVIS
- They'll need it.

Alice tosses wood on the fire place.

HOWARD
Careful dear. The fire will burn you.

ALICIA (V.O.)
It is what it does.

ALICE
(frustrated)
Thanks dear. I'd forgotten. It'd been so long since you burnt yourself. I'd blocked it out for old times sake.

ALICIA (V.O.)
That was a bit sarcastic. Burned him with your words.

Alice bids the men farewell and moves to the bedroom with the children.

ALICIA (V.O.) (CONT'D)
Babies! Oh they are so cute and I can only see the blankets.

Alice tucks in the children. BANG! The windows RATTLE!

FADE TO BLACK:

EXT. AVERYS - ACRES TREEHOUSE - NIGHT

ANGLE ON: Alicia glances at the night sky. She tilts her head left to see the YULE LOG.

INTO VIEW: Marianne with head lamp is looking over the railing. Alicia leans back and relaxes.

ALICIA
Mind traveling historian is so hard.

MARIANNE (O.S.)
You talking to yourself again?
(turning to Alicia)
I recorded your snoring if you want to hear it. The dead heard it because it woke them up.

ALICIA
Shouldn't your thinking come with a warning, siren or something.

MARIANNE
Oh, there is no label.
(pause)
For this girl, it's just going to be nice to ship you South of the Mason-Dixon. Free up some space for me and my crew.

ALICIA
You don't have a crew.

MARIANNE
It's what I call my cats. Jasper, Jorin and Jinx.

CLOSE ON: Marianne SWIPES the YULE LOG away. She taps the tablet to get a METEOR APP on her screen.

MARIANNE (CONT'D)
I've got the app to see the meteors, constellations and stars.

ALICIA
Kinda feels like cheating.

MARIANNE
It's being resourceful.

ALICIA
Still feels like cheating. I mean -
they didn't have an app for the
Mound Builders, Machu Picchu or the
pyramids.

MARIANNE
Didn't have school buses back in
the day. You going to walk to
tomorrow.

Marianne holds up the app to check that it works. Alicia
lifts herself up and struggles to get to Marianne.

ALICIA
If I star up too long, the STARS
are going to begin to move like a
merry-go-round. Reminds me of you
spinning around and falling off one
at the park.

MARIANNE
Oh. I'm a new feature in the space.
My technical name is Superstar.
It's a type of Nova. Can you help
hold this? My arms are getting
tired.

Alicia helps Marianne set up the table on the railing.

CUT TO:

INT. AVERYS MASTER BEDROOM - NIGHT

ANGLE ON: Rachel sits in the bed with SHEETS over her legs.
Glaring from the TELEVISION to Kyle who is standing at the
window.

ANGLE ON: Kyle's hand is opening the blind, holding
binoculars in his other hand.

RACHEL
What are you doing?

KYLE
Looking to see if it raining.

RACHEL
With lights off. Blinds closed and
and binoculars in your hand.
(MORE)

RACHEL (CONT'D)
Are you trying to count each drop
of rain? They'll be fine.
(pause)
Alicia's done this before. Fourth
year actually.

KYLE
True, but first year without you.
There are spiders, bugs and tree
snakes.

ANGLE ON: Rachel reluctantly gets up to go to the window.
She reaches for the binoculars.

RACHEL
Thanks. Now I've got to look too.
See what they're doing.

Alicia looks out the window.

EXT. AVERYS - ACRES TREEHOUSE - CONTINUOUS

IMAGE: Alicia and Marianne staring at the TABLET with the
NIGHT SKY above them.

RACHEL
We didn't use a tablet as kids to
look at the sky. Feels like
cheating.

KYLE
(sarcastically)
Concerned? You didn't put up much
of a fight when Alicia sub'd you
out.

Rachel looks at her husband.

RACHEL
I almost cried ... for joy. I don't
want to sleep on that thing and go
to school tomorrow.

KYLE
I still don't understand the half
day equals full snow day.

RACHEL
Stop trying. The girls are fine.
Now go to bed.

Rachel sets the binoculars down and gets back into bed.

RACHEL (CON'T) (CONT'D)
We've got a party for Ricky
tomorrow. For all the work, I don't
want to hear anyone show up and
complain. You know who I'm talking
about.

Kyles nods in agreement as he heads to bed.

KYLE
Brianna always says something.

CUT TO:

EXT. AVERYS - ACRES TREEHOUSE - NIGHT

CLOSE ON: Check off a CONSTELLATION sheet.

ALICIA (O.S.)
We got it. Field guide 1 done.

WIDE ON: Alicia and Marianne enjoy the VICTORY. Marianne puts
the YULE LOG back on the tablet. Alicia put the Constellation
paper away. They grab some RATIONS. Marianne YAWNS.

ALICIA (CONT'D)
Seriously. We aren't going to make
it to midnight. It's ... what time
is it?

MARIANNE
Little after eleven. We spent two
hours on constellation stuff. If
you include spacing out and
searching for Aliens.

ALICIA
What's next on the list?

Marianne SHRUGS her shoulders as she cocoons into her sheets
and covers herself in MOSQUITO NETTING.

MARIANNE
Lost the list again.

ALICIA
In your pocket? I'm too tired to
complain about this. Good night.

Alicia tucks herself under the covers. She makes herself
COMFY. She grabs the plastic folder and places fingers on the
LETTER.

ALICIA (V.O.)
Time to mind travel.

CUT TO:

INT - FARMHOUSE - GREAT ROOM - SUNSET

ANGLE ON: Alice tucks the children (1yr girl, 2yr girl, 4 yr boy) into BED. Howard LEANS on the door jamb to stare at his wife.

HOWARD
Alice.

Alice sighs, turns and smiles. Howard walks forward, leans down and HUGS the woman he loves. He gives a short kiss on her lips.

HOWARD (CONT'D)
Time for me to go. Did you finish
the letter?

Alicia nods 'YES'.

ALICE
I'll walk you out. Say good night
to the children first.

CLOSE ON: Howard kneels and kisses his children.

HOWARD
You be good Abigail. Stay out of
trouble Russell. Keep smiling
Joseph.

ALICIA (V.O.)
I was close. I thought the first
was Russell and second was Abigail.

ANGLE ON: Alice and Howard walk together into the GREAT ROOM. Corporal Davis and Corporal Averys make their way to the door, nod then leave. BANG! The windows RATTLE! Howard steps out the open door and SALUTES a standing COMMANDER REYNOLDS (40s, clean) as Alice holds the door open. She sees UNION SOLDIERS marching.

ALICIA (V.O.) (CON'T)
God. They're going to win the war.

Commander Reynolds scans the field. The commander fakes a smile.

ALICE

Commander. Do you enjoy your job?

COMMANDER REYNOLDS

By the grace of God this will end
for all the men.

ALICE

(snaps)

God is omniscient. Did he tell you
if my husband will come back?

ALICIA (V.O.)

(pause)

He doesn't come back Alice.

COMMANDER REYNOLDS

Fair enough.

(pause)

I've been given orders to have my
troops find their lines, dig holes
in the ground, and brace themselves
against Hell. Not the fire and
brimstone Hell that's been
politicized by demigods, born-
agains and pastors. This Hell isn't
a place for the dead to rest in
peace. It's the place men crawl
into when they remember the things
that are best forgotten; the hole
where men will replay every march,
maddening charge and massacre. I
don't enjoy sending them to war,
but I will give them the best
opportunity to hold their line.

Commander Reynolds walks away with his unit. Howard enters
the line with a LIMP.

ALICE

I don't enjoy writing a WILL.

Alice turns and shuts the door.

CLOSE ON: Alice struggles to keep her composure. Her stress
is EXHALED. She makes her way to her children who sleep in
their bassinets. BANG! The windows RATTLE!

CUT TO:

EXT. AVERYS - ACRES TREEHOUSE - EARLY MORNING

CLOSE ON: Rachel nudges Alicia up. Alicia swipes the hand away. Rachel nudges Alicia up. Alicia swipes then pushes away the hand. Rachel shakes her head in CONTEMPT.

RACHEL
Time to wake up!

ANGLE ON: Alicia SHOOTs up, sees her fate, then tucks back into bed.

TRACKING SHOT: Rachel starts her way back down the steps. Marianne is on the ground.

RACHEL (CONT'D)
Time to wake up. If I have to go to school so do you.

MARIANNE
Can we get paid for school like you?

RACHEL
No. That'd raise my taxes.

ALICIA (O.S.)
Hey. Wait up!

Marianne turns, walks backwards while staring at Alicia running to catch up.

MARIANNE
At-least it's not raining!

Marianne turns back and continues with Rachel onto the deck. Rachel slides open the deck doors as they both walk through.

CUT TO:

INT. AVERYS DINNING ROOM - CONTINUOUS

CLOSE ON: The TABLE is set with Blueberry MUFFINS and ORANGE JUICE.

ANGLE ON: Rachel GRABS a MUFFIN and TUMBLER of juice.

RACHEL
Grab and go this morning. I don't want to be late.

MARIANNE

I wouldn't mind showing up when
school's over.

Marianne (normal dress) grabs a MUFFIN. Alicia (purple dress)
enters and grabs a MUFFIN. Kyle offers Rachel a second
tumbler of COFFEE.

KYLE

Save some for everyone else please,
which is me. Did you see any bears,
cougars or things that can kill?

RACHEL

Did I really say I do?

ALICIA AND MARIANNE

For better or worse.

Marianne and Alicia enter the hallway with their food.

KYLE

Speaking of school-

RACHEL

- You weren't speaking of school -

KYLE

- I am now. News this morning said
that someone vandalized the school
last night.

ANGLE ON (OTS): Rachel SPITS out some juice. Kyle is shocked
at the waste.

KYLE (CONT'D)

The reporter said it was more
disruptive than destructive. It
wasn't enough to cancel school, but
there are going to a few local
police and the sheriff for class.

RACHEL

What are the details? I need to
know what I'm getting into.

KYLE

Not 100% certain.

RACHEL

How certain are you? 5, 10, 20%.

KYLE

Let's say ninety. I saw pictures.

PATRICK (O.S.)
What pictures dad?

MASON
Simple minds want to know.

ANGLE DOWN (OTS) Rachel and Kyle pause as they look up and down at their boys.

CLOSE ON: Patrick (70s style, high socks, headband) stands aside Mason (Mismatched style).

KYLE
Are those my socks Patrick?

ANGLE ON: Knee high gold, white and maroon socks pushed down.

PATRICK
Yeah, last day of school. We all dress like old people. You're my inspiration this year.

KYLE
Pull up or off. None of this half 70s stuff. And I wasn't around in the 70s thank you very much.

CLOSE ON: Patrick pulls the socks up to his knees. Alicia and Marianne stand in the hallway BEHIND the boys.

ALICIA
Let's go! Hippy kid and I don't even know. How are you older than me and dress like that?

MASON
Have you seen yourself? You look like a plum!

The four children leave the room with ALL the remaining food. Kyle turns to Rachel.

KYLE
Want to know about the pictures?

RACHEL
No.

CLOSE ON: Kyle is surprised as Rachel starts to leave.

KYLE
I've been waiting to tell someone all morning.

RACHEL

I'll see it myself. You've got HVAC with Bill. Call him to tell him about the pictures. He will fall asleep while you talk, but he'll respond with a snoring song.

DOLLY ON: Rachel exits the room and enters the hallway. She NODS for the kids to OPEN the front door to leave. Rachel SIGHS, grabs her keys and exits the front door. The door closes behind her.

CUT TO BLACK.

EXT. ROSSMOYNE DROP OFF LANE - MORNING

ANGLE ON: Marianne, Celenia and Alicia stand at the DROP OFF LANE (roadway, sidewalk, school to the right). The roadway has cars lined DROPPING OFF the children. A BUS is STUCK in line. The SIDEWALK is full of students walking towards the MAIN doors.

CLOSE ON: Marianne lowers her sunglasses.

MARIANNE

What type of tree is that?

ALICIA

Not a normal one.

CELENIA

It used to be oak.

GINO (14 years, tall) knocks into Marianne who is startled.

MARIANNE

Slow down before you run someone over! Freaking Ogre!

CELENIA

He's not even green.

ALICIA

Pre-neanderthal maybe.

CELENIA

I can yell all the nice things you say about Gino.

ANGLE ON: Marianne shakes off the comments, then LEADS the three closer to the roadway.

MARIANNE

Less me, more this.
(raising hands)
How long did this take? To be
honest, I like the look.

ALICIA

I'm on the fence. I mean, such a
waste of toilet paper. How many
rolls did they use? Why so many
trees?

WIDE ON: ALL TWELVE TREES have toilet paper thrown throughout
the branches. The paper SWAYS with the wind.

CELENIA

You question everything? How many?
Why so? Blah, blah, blah. I don't
question this level of stupid.
Let's go before we get detention
for being late.

ANGLE ON: The three turn and enter the CROWD to make their
way towards the doors. The crowd moves SWIFTLY until a SUDDEN
STOP. Marianne steps into Alicia who narrowly avoids Celenia.
They glance towards the GRASS.

CLOSE ON: TWO HUNDRED FORKS in the shape of an 'A'.

MARIANNE

What the...?

CELENIA

Why?

ALICIA

Look who is questioning now?

CELENIA

You're wondering what? How? Who did
this?

ALICIA

Nope. Too dumb for me to care.

MR. BAYER (O.S.)

Keep it moving!

ANGLE ON: MR. BAYER (40s, tall, teacher) towers at the DOOR
to guide students inside the building.

MR. BAYER (CONT'D)

Don't want to get run over on the
last day of school.

ANGLE DOWN: The students pass Mr. Bayer to enter the MAIN DOORS.

CUT TO:

INT. ROSSMOYNE SCHOOL HALLWAY - CONTINUOUS

ANGLE ON: STUDENTS part around teachers like MOSES was standing in the way. Each STUDENT starts to attract to SIMILAR STUDENTS. ECHOS of WHO DID IT? Are in the halls. Alicia, Marianne and Celenia keep together.

ALICIA (V.O.)
Aren't there better things to talk about.

ANGLE UP: They see the HALLWAY WINDOWS covered in WHITE SOAP FIGURES and LETTERS. Celenia shakes her head. Marianne can barely contain her laughter.

ALICIA (V.O.) (CONT'D)
What a waste of everything?

TRACKING SHOT: Celenia and Marianne wave by then peel off towards their HOMEROOM. Alicia trudges on to the end of the hall passing PICTURE from the SCHOOL YEAR. She glances at the bulletin board MR. DONHUE'S ROOM (standard class room, windows and pictures of SCIENCE).

INT. ROSSMOYNE SCHOOL HALLWAY - CONTINUOUS

ANGLE ON: The room is FOUR COLUMN by SIX ROW setup for homeroom and ASTRONOMY. Alicia takes her window seat and RELAXES.

CLOSE ON: The back of ALICIA can be seen as CATBOY (13 yrs) leans towards Alicia from the seat BEHIND.

CATBOY
Psss. Psss.

ANGLE ON: Alicia ignores Catboy.

ANGLE ON: Catboy leans closer to Alicia.

CATBOY (CONT'D)
Psss. Psss. Did you see all the forks in the ground?

CLOSE ON: Alicia sits in silence as her face turns RED.

ANGLE ON (OTS): Alicia looks towards MR. DONHUE (20s, astronomy teacher) who takes the center of the classroom.

MR. DONHUE
Simmer Down and take your seats.

CATBOY (O.S.)
Psss.

CLOSE ON: Alicia contains her rage, turns to Catboy.

ALICIA
Psss. Psss. Psss. Psss.
(soft voice)
That's cat code for I DO NOT CARE.

ANGLE ON (OTS): Alicia turns to stare at the final STUDENTS taking their seats and Mr. Donhue sitting at the front table.

MR. DONHUE
Channel 7 news is cancelled this morning. Rather than learning things, we have a special report from Principal Perez.

ALICIA (V.O.)
Sanctuary! All I want is sanctuary!

ANGLE ON: Catboy sits on the edge of his seat. Alicia lowers herself into her seat.

MR. DONHUE
(singing out of tune)
He'll be comin' over the PA system
when he comes. He'll be comin'
round the PA system, coming round
the PA system.

ALICIA (V.O.)
(drowning out Mr. Donhue)
If only I could hit my head on the
desk to become unconscious. It'd be
so much better than listening to
him sing a horrible song. AH, here
comes the principal.

CLOSE ON: PRINCIPAL PEREZ (50s, balding) is broadcast on the television from a small studio with a SUMMER BEACH background.

PRINCIPAL PEREZ

Good morning students and faculty. As you are no doubt aware, our school has undergone some redecorating last night. A mix of kitchen utensils in the lawn and bathroom products on the trees and windows. It will be necessary to relocate some classes to the auditorium for the day. Since the auditorium does not currently have a functional air conditioning system, the room is about 15 degrees warmer than every classroom. I doubt many people will consider it the best place to be for a forty-five-minute class. It is also necessary to cancel the outdoor picnic during the last period due to the vandalism; so you should expect to stay in your last classroom the entire time.

ALICIA (V.O.)

Just crossed 10 minutes Perez. I should have stayed in the treehouse. Heck, avoiding the tree leaches would be more entertaining.

PRINCIPAL PEREZ

I ask anyone who has information about the people who vandalized the school to notify your teacher or come to the administration office. Any information that is given will be confidential and no names will be released. I thank you for your time and hope that you have a great day.

The television goes BLACK.

ANGLE ON: Mr. Donhue turns to the class. He pauses to scan the student's faces. A bunch of 2, 4, and a sole 10 staring out the window.

MR. DONHUE

Any response from the audience?

LENNY (12 yrs, glasses) raises his hand.

LENNY

I've got a question. Let's consider an example.

MR. DONHUE

Example away Mr. Dineymore. The court is in session and you are the lawyer or jester. Choice is yours.

LENNY

I prefer student. Anyway, if someone goes into the office. Then comes to class late, won't that end the anonymous feature of the principal's plan?

MR. DONHUE

Could. Or the student is coming from bathroom break, locker got stuck. Who knows?

ED

(mumbling too loud)
What a waste.

ANGLE ON: The STUDENTS EYES grow WIDE. MR. Donhue bites his lip as he glances at ED (12 yrs, smallest student). Ed slowly slips down into his seat.

MR. DONHUE

Did you say something Ed?
(pausing)
We can still see you Ed.

Ring! Ring! Ring!

TRACKING SHOT: Ed stands, then runs up the row. Alicia sits and waits to be the last one out.

MR. DONHUE (CONT'D)

Why the hurry Ed?

ALICIA (V.O.)

Why be in a hurry to hear the same story told fifty different ways? New rumors from people who heard something from someone. I hate drama that I didn't create. It's so blah.

FADE TO BLACK:

INT. ROSSMOYNE SCHOOL HALLWAY - CONTINUOUS

ANGLE ON: Alicia EXITS the classroom to a hallway of CHATTER. She makes her way forward, nearly missing one backpack after another. She makes the CORNER where Celenia STANDS glaring at the crowd around the MATH DOOR.

ALICIA
This looks promising, not.

The PACK of students maneuvers towards a closed doorway that is TOO SMALL.

CELENIA
I'm thinking we're not going to
have class here. The mob is a bit
of giveaway.

CLOSE ON: Alicia grinds her teeth in frustration at her predicament. Celenia frowns from the side at the GRINDING.

CELENIA (CONT'D)
If you keep grinding your teeth,
you'll get an overbite.
(glancing at the mob)
It's probably just the windows or
something.

ALICIA
That something is ruining my day --

ANGLE ON: Alicia maneuvers towards the crowd.

ALICIA (CONT'D)
Let's see how bad this is going to
go.

Alicia stops at the edge of the crowd. Tilting left, then right, lastly up on her tippy toes, there is no gap.

CLOSE ON: MAX (14yrs, giant) clears a path from the door through the edge. Alicia maneuvers through the gap, past the students who are TAKEN BACK by MAX'S MARCH.

ALICIA (V.O.)
Stay out of my way. I'm --

Alicia stares, first in line at the door which boasts a FLOURESCENT POSTERBOARD.

CLOSE ON: Fluorescent Posterboard. It reads -

'ALL STUDENTS...this means you two. All classes of-ten held in Room 137 will be in the auditorium. It will be gr-eight if everyone is on time. Mr. J-one-s.'

CLOSE ON: Alicia exhales the stress, then as if PLANNED, a elbow from behind impacts Alicia's back. The impact was minimal, barely noticeable, Alicia slowly turns.

ALICIA (CON'T)
We're in the auditorium Celenia.
It's on the other side of the
school. I'm not a long-distance
walker. Will you carry me.

CLOSE ON: Celenia annoyed face.

CELENIA
Did you really ask me to carry you?

ALICIA
The auditorium is on the other side
of the school.

CELENIA
You can do it.

ALICIA
I'm not a long-distance walker.

ANGLE ON: Alicia and Celenia begin exiting the mob, then turn to the right and walk the hallway.

TRACKING SHOT: Alicia and Celenia walk the long hallway with students scattering and SOAPED windows to their side.

ALICIA (CONT'D)
I don't have the energy this
morning. Plus, it's not my
exercise day.

CELENIA
I didn't know you had an exercise
day. You've been keeping secrets
from me. I thought we were friends.

ALICIA
We are, you just haven't been
around for my exercise day. It's
February 29th. Happens once every
four years. We've haven't been
friends that long. Next year, I'll
invite you.

TRACKING SHOT: The two begin the trek down the hall THINNING students in the hall. They agree WITHOUT WORDS to slow-down and stretch the passing time to the auditorium. Their goal is not to be first - it is JUST to make it.

INTERCUT: Images of bulletin boards. ASTRONOMY, ECONOMY, TAXES.

ALICIA (V.O.)
When are we ever going to need any
of this stuff?

Angle On: The ladies approach the WIDE-OPEN auditorium door. A BOY (12 yrs) with SWEAT STAINS on his shirt exits auditorium, turns then pass Alicia's right. There's a GLANCE from Alicia that cuts the BOY in half.

CUT TO:

INT. ROSSMOYNE AUDITORIUM - CONTINUOUS

MUSIC - THE SECRET GARDEN BROADWAY CAST - IT'S A MAZE.

DOLLY FORWARD: Alicia and Celenia are SET between the AUDITORIUM DOORS. They WALK ASIDE the other down the aisle that separates the red chairs.

ANGLE UP: Glancing at the ceiling, the two-story room has AIR VENTS that DON'T move the RIBBONS.

ANGLE DOWN: The girls approach a table with MR. JONES (40s math teacher) and MS. JONES (30s, history teacher). Alicia and Celenia show a 5 as Ms. Jones uses a PAPER FAN to stay cool.

CLOSE ON: Partially completed SIGN IN sheet. Alicia gets close to the sheet and scans the FIRST PAGE. She points to her name, then signs for herself AND Celenia.

ANGLE ON: Alicia steps aside the table to let Celenia search. Celenia comes up blank.

CELENIA
Did you sign my name?

ALICIA
Yeah, I thought I would make it
easier --

ANGLE ON: Alicia starts to walk away from the table back up the aisle.

ALICIA (CONT'D)

--You can sign my name again if you want. I don't care.

INTERCUT: Uncomfortable students SHOW a 1, 2, and 3.

ANGLE DOWN: Celenia stops at the SECOND to last row. She makes eye contact with those IN THE ROW. No words, just an understanding for each one to STAND UP. Celenia makes her way carefully through to seat 'Q' Alicia in a subtle way takes seat 'T' to Celenia's side. Celenia shakes her head in embarrassment as Alicia sits.

CELENIA

You don't have to apologize to everyone. They know the etiquette of auditorium class. Sit down. Relax. Sleep or talk. They're not going to barricade the row so you can't get in. Oh and don't sign my name again. It took me a month to perfect my signature, and I dislike someone else faking my name.

ALICIA

I know that's why I did it.

CELENIA

(failing to get comfy)
I know you, know. That's --

MELISSA (O.S.)

Celenia!

ANGLE DOWN (OTS): Celenia makes eye contact with MELISSA (13 yrs, girl) two rows up and five seats down. There glares show the RIVALRY.

MELISSA (CONT'D)

You going to be at practice on Saturday?

CELENIA

Yeah, I'll be there. What time are you showing up?

ANGLE DOWN (OTS): Alicia sees Celenia biting her LIP in annoyance.

MELISSA

Whenever. Brother has a game on Field D a little earlier, so I'll probably just walk over from there. We're wearing white, right?

CELENIA

Yep. We're the home team. White shirt, green shorts and white socks.

ALICIA

(snickering)

You make a great teammate, don't cha? Rumor has it you two are trying to get the most red cards?

CLOSE ON: Celenia rolls her eyes right to Alicia.

CELENIA

(rolling her eyes)

Every day there's a new rumor about someone. If someone's going to spend their time thinking of me, great! I don't mind being the center of attention. Actually, I think I should be the center of attention more often. It'd make people happier.

ANGLE ON: The two try unsuccessfully to get comfortable. Alicia sees Michael start to make his way down the aisle in-front of her aisle.

ALICIA

(distracted)

I don't think you're joking.

CLOSE ON: Michael takes the seat in-front of Celenia and has his OVERSIZED SATCHEL across his shoulder. Michael glances back at Celenia and Alicia.

MICHAEL

Ladies! Running late, but I just thought I'd grace you with my presence.

ALICIA

Well, my grace. I like your man purse.

ANGLE ON: Michael is TAKEN BACK by the comment. He hides his SATCHEL behind his back. He takes a seat, pauses, then turns himself back to see Celenia and Alicia.

MICHAEL

It's not a purse.

CELENIA

Looks like one. It is one.

CLOSE ON: Celenia's eyes are wide open and staring into Michael's face. She's burning lasers into his forehead. They wait for the other to respond.

CELENIA (CONT'D)

Well, do you have a comeback?

MICHAEL

(defeated)

No. I have a satchel. It's much better than a purse and I don't have to carry that make-up crap either.

CELENIA

Oh, no, no.

ALICIA

Oh, no, no

CELENIA (CONT'D)

Makeup isn't crap, it's great. I think you could use some eyeliner.

ALICIA

Would you say blue or pink?

CELENIA

Blue would be too manly for a guy
with a purse. I'm going with pink?

CLOSE ON: Michael turns back in defeat.

MICHAEL

I'm glad to hear you two know how I should look. I'll take it into consideration.

ANGLE ON: Alicia leans up to his side.

ALICIA

(quietly)

While you're considering it, can I borrow your purse? It looks like a good pillow.

Michael hands over the SATCHEL to Alicia. She examines the green bag with fake faded pockets.

ALICIA (V.O.)

This would make a great purse.
Pockets for everything and I've
many things to fill them.

CLOSE ON: She tucks the satchel BEHIND her head.

ALICIA

This will definitely work. Shame you didn't have two that way we'd both have one. Wake me when it's time to leave.

(she side-eyes Celenia)

Don't leave me like Marianne did?

CELENIA

It's not raining.

Alicia shakes her head in AMUSEMENT. She adjusts, FINALLY COMFORTABLE. She closes her eyes to SLEEP.

CUT TO:

INT. BOSCOVS DEPARTMENT STORE PURSE SECTION - AFTERNOON

The racks of the DEPARTMENT STORE are FULL of accessories of handbags, purses, satchels and hats. Michael examines the SATCHEL.

ECU - inside the satchel then outside pockets.

ANGLE ON: Michael holds it up and nods. Just past the CARDIGANS to his right is JAMIE MORRISON (40s, Michael's mother).

CLOSE ON: Jamie lowers her SUNGLASSES.

JAIME

Are you really going to get that.
Might work for my clothes, but I
don't know about yours.

ANGLE ON: Michael stares, then smiles at Jamie.

MICHAEL

It'll work.

ALICIA (V.O.)

Not if it's what I think it is.

Michael TOSSES the satchel over his back, then makes his way to Jamie who is FLIPPING Cardigans, examining the details.

MICHAEL

It's bigger than anything on the
men's side. How much money do I
have? --

CLOSE ON: Jaime CHECKS her purse. The wallet does have cash in it.

ALICIA (V.O.)
 Tell him he's broke Mrs. Morrison.
 Don't let him buy it. Though I know
 he does buy it, please tell him.
 You have my permission to change
 the course of history.

JAMIE
 You have enough if you want it. Do
 you really want it?

MICHAEL
 (confidently)
 I'm gonna get it. If anyone makes
 fun of me, I'll just shrug it off.
 Won't even respond.

ALICIA (V.O.)
 Liar! And it's still a purse.

FADE TO BLACK.

EXT. ROSSMOYNE DROP OFF LANE - NIGHT

PITCH BLACK

ALICIA (V.O.)
 What are you doing now? More
 purses! Where's the light? This is
 not working for a Qualified Mind
 Traveler like me!

CLOSE ON: Michael pulls his hand from the SATCHEL. He adjusts
 to the DARKNESS of the SCHOOL ENTRANCE AREA.

MICHAEL
 (loudly)
 It's a Summer surprise. We didn't
 want to go to school in June so
 this is our thank you gift.

ANGLE ON: Michael glances to his side at a SHADOWY FIGURE
 whose name is TRAVIS NOBLE (14 yrs).

TRAVIS
 (leans down, to pick up
 something)
 I did like the snow-days in
 January. I remember the snowball
 fight between Fort Napoleon and
 Fort Snowball.

ANGLE ON: Michael stands up to take a LAY OF THE LAND.

WIDE ANGLE: A line of trees with someone standing in the shadows of the tree. The area behind is ASLEEP, no cars, only streetlights and STARS from the sky.

MICHAEL

I remember the screaming, Save me
Seymour! Snowball in the face!
Haha. That hurt him so bad.

ALICIA (V.O.)

Turn left so I can see whose
annoyingly deep voice is on your
side -- I know, but I can't place
it.

CLOSE ON: Michael bends down and reaches into the SATCHEL.
The shadow of Travis with ORANGE SHOES and a SPARKLING WATCH
are near.

TRAVIS NOBLE (O.S.)

Did you buy two-ply because I only
use the best. There are certain
standards that I don't want to
compromise.

Michael grabs a roll of TOILET PAPER out of the satchel.

MICHAEL

No. That would be a waste of good
toilet paper. Single-ply is
cheaper. And my allowance isn't
that big so you're going to have to
work with it.

ANGLE ON: Michael TOSSES the toilet paper from one hand to
the other. He stretches his arm for a THROW. A large circle
of his right hand with the toilet paper. He senses Travis
aside him, pauses.

MICHAEL (CONT'D)

You're in my personal space. Since
I outrank you, I don't think you
can do that.

(preparing to throw)

How epic of a failure it will be if
we get caught.

ALICIA (V.O.)

Oh my god. We're at school! Why'd
it take me so long to figure it
out? --

ANGLE ON (OTS): Michael SLINGS a roll of toilet paper towards a figure at the CLOSEST TREE. He and Travis watch the flight path.

ALICIA (V.O.) (CONT'D)
 -- Oh, that's right, I didn't think
 you were that STUPID. Silly me, how
 much of a fool you are in life. --

ANGLE ON: The figure, Daniel McKean (14 yrs) catches the toilet paper in the SHADOWS. His features are unseen. He holds UP his TROPHY to Michael and Travis.

MICHAEL
 Get on with it!

ANGLE UP: Daniel switches the roll from his right hand to his left hand. Pulling back to the point of no return, Snap! The arm extends UP.

CLOSE ON: Michael's eyes jerk up. He sees...nothing.

ANGLE ON: Michael stares down towards Daniel.

DANIEL
 (obnoxiously)
 Psych! You all thought I'd throw
 it, didn't you! Didn't you think it
 would be launching like a
 spaceship, thrusters on! You
 should have seen your eyes! They
 were lit up like the moon, all big
 and bright! Ha!

ALICIA (V.O.)
 No way that loser saw your eyes
 from that distance.

MICHAEL
 As vice president, I motion to fire
 the secretary, effective
 immediately.

TRAVIS
 Motion denied.
 (pause)
 I need his bike to get back home.
 Tonight is taking us four hours.

MICHAEL
 I'm not walking two miles home
 after all this.
 (towards Daniel)
 Keep it down over there!
 (MORE)

MICHAEL (CONT'D)
You're going wake the dead with all
that noise! --

ANGLE ON: Michael tosses another roll of toilet paper to
Daniel.

ALICIA (V.O.)
And your yelling is going to help
how? Ugg. Even in my dreams, I
can't escape this. I'm STUCK in
this auditorium because of you and
your minions. Mr. Vice President,
you are going to be impeached.
Removed from power. Prestige isn't
all you were getting when you
decided to do this. Now you've made
an enemy in me. I'm going find a
way to get you fools back. Mark my
words.

IMAGE CUT: The THIRD tree has toilet paper. A roll passes an
unsuspecting SQUIRREL. A roll lands in a bird nest.

EXT. ROSSMOYNE MAIN DOOR AREA - NIGHT

ANGLE ABOVE: Michael has a BOX of 100 forks in each HAND.
INTO VIEW: Travis stands to his side. They stare at a grassy
knoll aside the main doors. Michael is pointing towards the
grass.

MICHAEL
I'm putting two hundred forks into
the ground. People are going to
notice.

ANGLE ON: Michel kneels down aside Travis. Michael starts to
place the forks. Travis is gathering his soap supplies.

ALICIA (V.O.)
Walk towards the light! I want to
see your face. Not the shadows of
your scrawny frame all five feet
something in height. It's not
Halloween, yet your shoes are
hideously bright orange shoes.
Orange!

MICHAEL
I've got the forks covered. You
just get the soap ready.

ALICIA

Travis Noble! You maniacal brat.
Should have figured it out. You
can't hide from me. I know it's
you...you're the only one who
colors their shoes like a
construction cone. If I have class
with you again, I'm going to make a
paper airplane then land it on your
forehead. I'll say I was aiming for
the desk or whatever is near, but
you're my target.

ANGLE ON: Travis juggles a few bars of soap ...

TRAVIS

I'm only ninety-seven percent
certain what I want to write. I
mean everything I do is a
masterpiece. How's it feel to be
surrounded by greatness Michael?

MICHAEL

I'll let you know when I get there.
(glancing up)
I thought you had it all written
down.

TRAVIS

I did. I just forgot the papers at
home.

ALICIA (V.O.)

Forget yourself at home, jerk.

ANGLE ON (OTS): Travis walks towards the main doors as
Michael stands.

MICHAEL

Remind me how you got to have such
a high position in the group.

TRAVIS

I can write in cursive and its
legible cursive.

ALICIA (V.O.)

Can't deny that. It's better than
mine. Ha, you write better than a
girl.

TRAVIS

Can you leave the forks for a minute? I want to draw more than a blank.

CLOSE ON: Michael leaves his hill and walks towards Travis who is staring at the large windows aside the main doors.

CUT TO:

INT. ROSSMOYNE SCHOOL AUDITORIUM - CONTINUOUS

CLOSE ON: Alicia SNAPS up from her chair. Her face is read.

ANGLE DOWN: Alicia stares ahead. Celenia is silently talking to Alicia who grasps the SATCHEL and throws it at Michael. Michael is SHOCKED.

ALICIA

It's a purse. I'll be back.

TRACKING SHOT: Alicia starts to walk down the aisle past RELUCTANT students. The background stage has **Secret Garden - A Place of Peace and Serenity** - a flowery, ornate, play.

ALICIA (V.O.)

I want to Yell. Scream and break some ear drums. Well, only those that ruined my day and put me in this sauna of a room.

TRACKING SHOT: Alicia exits the row, scans the rooms and identifies the teacher table.

ALICIA (V.O.) (CONT'D)

There's my target --

She quickens her pace down the aisle.

CAMERA ON: Mr. Jones (male teacher) and Ms. Jones (female teacher) sit at the sign-in table talking back and forth.

MR. JONES

I've got a week till I start painting all Summer. 10 hours a day is rough, cash under the table is always good. You start yet?

MS. JAMES

Nope. I planned all year to get the Summer off. Joined a Summer volleyball league though. Two wins no losses.

INTO VIEW: Alicia greets the table with a 5. Ms. Jones displays a 9.

ALICIA
(curtly)
I need to leave.

MS. JAMES
Try again. Can we help you? --

MR. JONES
Sounds like one of mine.

ANGLE ON: Mr. Jones turns around.

MR. JONES (CONT'D)
Alicia Averys I presume.

ALICIA
Been that all year.
(checking her tone)
May I please leave?

MR. JONES
Fifteen minutes till the end. Can
it waltz?

ALICIA
Bathroom break.

MS. JAMES MR. JONES
Go. We'll watch your stuff.

ANGLE ON: Alicia turns and walks away from the table towards the open auditorium doors.

MR. JONES (CONT'D)
Celenia! Watch Alicia's stuff!

CELENIA
I've got it!

TRACKING SHOT: Alicia walks up the aisle.

CLOSE ON: Alicia burns holes in Michael head from this distance.

CUT TO:

INT. ROSSMOYNE SCHOOL HALLWAY - CONTINUOUS

TRACKING SHOT: MUSIC STARTS (MOBY - Natural Blues). Alicia
EXITS the auditorium and enters a BARREN hallway.

No teachers. No students. Just bits of paper BLOWING by like TUMBLEWEEDS. Alicia turns to the left and continues walking.

ALICIA (V.O.)
I'm mad. Nope. Past that point,
over the bridge, turned and burnt
the bridge. Not going back.

TRACKING SHOT: She passes bulletin boards of tessellations and art to her side. The low sound of CLASSICAL MUSIC interrupts her walk...she stops.

CLOSE ON: Alicia examines the art.

ALICIA (V.O.) (CONT'D)
Demote every kid two years to
fourth grade.

TRACKING SHOT: Alicia turns and walks left.

ALICIA (V.O.) (CONT'D)
I'm too stressed. It's only a day.
No half-day. Not a full day of
annoyance. I can let it go, left it
slide right off.

CLOSE ON: Alicia turns the corner and is MET by MISSY (13 yrs). They are both startled, step back, then continue their course.

ALICIA
Hey!

MISSY
Hey!

TRACKING SHOT: Alicia cuts past Missy.

CAMERA ON: Missy continuing back the hallway. She turns left and enters the classroom.

CUT TO:

INT. ROSSMOYNE SCHOOL HOME ECONOMICS - CONTINUOUS

MR. BOSANI'S (40s) stands at the front of the room with a SEWING MACHINE on the table. CLASSICAL MUSIC plays loudly. Missy avoids eye contact with everyone but the GROUND.

MR. BOSANI
Since we don't have any volunteers.
Missy?

ANGLE ON: Missy shuffles into her seat, then with EYE CONTACT to Mr. Bosani. He disconnects then peers for volunteers.

MR. BOSANI (CONT'D)
We have a victim? Volunteer, so
sorry.

ANGLE ON: Missy looks right to see Patrick with his hand held high, walks down the aisle.

MR. BOSANI (CONT'D)
Are you certain you can handle
this? Step right up. You all know
the rules! -

PATRICK
- I don't know the rules.

MR. BOSANI
(shocked)
Then why'd you volunteer? Why risk
humiliation at the sight of the
starting line.

CLOSE ON: Patrick stands next to Mr. Bosani who towers above him.

PATRICK
It's the last day of class. What do
I have to loss?

ALICIA (O.S.)
Everything. Make him sweat?

MR. BOSANI
Daring and bold Mr. Averys.

ANGLE ON: Mr. Bosani looks at the doorway as Patrick slowly turns to see his sister standing, SMIRKING at him.

MR. BOSANI (CONT'D)
Shouldn't you be in class. I mean,
glad you like my class, but you
passed it and no longer have to
come back.

ALICIA
I'm on my way back to the
auditorium. Mr. Jones.

CLOSE ON: Mr. Bosani nods his head in agreement.

MR. BOSANI
I'd be in the hallway too if I had
Mr. Jones. Can't really fault you
there.

Alicia turns and exits the doorway.

CUT TO:

INT. ROSSMOYNE SCHOOL HALLWAY - CONTINUOUS

CLASSICAL MUSIC starts to fade.

ANGLE ON: Alicia walks back past the bulletin boards of
tessellations,

ALICIA (V.O.)
What if I succeed at knowing who
vandalized the school? Maybe I
won't tell. That could be fun.
Rather than going to the principal,
maybe I can be the cop, judge and
jury. It would be a good way to get
revenge for my horrible day! Half-
day, Alicia! How are you going to
prove you are a mind-traveler to
anyone? Riding shot-gun in a
vandal's mind may make me an
accomplice. I don't want to go to
jail. I've got a trip to Savannah
this Summer.

WIDE ON: Alicia smiles to Mr. Jones who is monitoring the
entrance doors. She turns into the auditorium.

CUT TO:

INT. ROSSMOYNE SCHOOL AUDITORIUM - CONTINUOUS

ANGLE ON (OTS) Alicia marks her seat in her FIELD OF VIEW.
Alicia doesn't deviate from her vision, her seat and Michael.
STUDENTS raise their legs to let her walk through the aisle.
Alicia takes her seat as a moment passes to BALANCE her
options - picks her emotions.

ALICIA
Hey Michael. Marianne and I went
camping last night. What'd you do?

MICHAEL
(dismissive)
Nothing. Just stayed home and
played some video games online.

ALICIA (V.O.)
Liar

ALICIA
(quizzical)
Sounds like fun. What'd you play?

ANGLE ON: Michael hesitates. Alicia sits in the background.

ALICIA (V.O.)
He doesn't want to say.

MICHAEL
Standard football game.

ALICIA
Oh. Too bad, I don't play those
kinds of games.

ALICIA (V.O.)
I'm a detective.

ALICIA
Perhaps we'll find a game we both
like.

ALICIA (V.O.)
You won't like the one I'm playing.

ALICIA
(normal voice)
Did you win? What was the score?
Did you run or pass? Inquiring
minds, like mine, want to know.

RING! RING! RING!

WIDE ON: Everyone rises. Michael slings his SATCHEL over his
shoulder. Alicia keeps her eyes on him. Alicia follows
Celenia as they single file out of the row and turn towards
the EXIT.

CUT TO:

INT. ROSSMOYNE SCHOOL HALLWAY - CONTINUOUS

IMAGES: SHADOWS walking across the ground, Silhouettes on the
ground from windows.

ANGLE ON (OTS): Alicia is walking through the hallway, windows on each side. In the distance are the CATTLE SHOOTs from construction, six lanes of students reduce to two. Celenia enters from the RIGHT. A few additional steps of SILENCE, then Marianne joins on the left. The three turn to the right so see the WINDOWS OF SOAP - unknown meaning, some familiar symbols.

CELENIA

Looks like someone just made up a language on the windows. I'll be happy when this day is over. I don't even know if my class will be in class or if I'm going have to walk all the way back to the auditorium.

MARIANNE

Yeah, it'd be easier if they just sent everyone a text or gave directions on the speaker system to go home.

CLOSE ON: Alicia ignores the conversation, focusing instead on a DODGING backpack in-front that belongs to PATRICK.

ALICIA (V.O.)

I see you brother!

CELENIA

The writing just keeps going.

ANGLE ON: TWO JANITORS are WASHING the WINDOWS outside.

ALICIA

It's not really fair for them to have to clean it all up. They didn't do it. And because of all this stupid, we don't get to go outside. People who had nothing, absolutely zero to do with the vandalism now get punished. I'd do a lot worse to the people who did this.

CLOSE ON: Celenia and Marianne roll their eyes in different directions, laughs.

CELENIA

A bit serious. Guess I'd figure out something. The police captain is my uncle; I could tell him. Now you've got me thinking about who did it.

(MORE)

CELENIA (CONT'D)
Why do you always do that to me
Alicia?

ALICIA (V.O.)
Because I know two names.

ALICIA
Travis is in your next class,
right?

CELENIA
Which one? We've got Travis A, N,
and U. I hope you don't mean U.

ALICIA
Nobel?

CELENIA
Yeah. My cousin is in my class.
Why?

CLOSE ON: Marianne laughs at the question.

MARIANNE
Never ask Alicia why?

ANGLE ON: Alicia and Celenia slow down before the CATTLE
SHOOTS.

ALICIA
Since Travis is basically the crazy
kid, who escaped crazy town. I want
to borrow his watch.

CELENIA
(confused)
Why? What?

CLOSE ON: Marianne barely contains her laughter.

MARIANNE
I need to stop giving advice. You
just asked Alicia a second question
- a WHY question.

ALICIA
I just want to borrow it. I'd give
it back to him at the game. His
brothers on the other team and
he'll be there. I promise.

ANGLE ON (OTS): Celenia, Alicia, and Marianne stop in their
tracks, disrupting the area BEFORE the narrowing cattle
shoots.

CLOSE ON: Celenia looks at Alicia.

CELENIA

You're not telling me the whole truth. I'll do it for my own amusement. Eventually you've got to tell me the truth. I've earned that over the past few years.

ALICIA

I will.

ANGLE ON: Alicia continues walking down the cattle shoots. Celenia EXHALES the stress. Marianne passes Celenia with a LAUGH. Marianne exits right. Celenia left. Alicia enters the cattle shoots.

CUT TO BLACK.

INT. ROSSMOYNE SCHOOL FOREIGN LANGUAGE - CONTINUOUS

CLOSE ON: Celenia sits in the CORNER seat. She glances at the walls which show Spanish Conquistadors, DEUTSCH FOOD, and LATIN NUMERALS.

ANGLE ON (OTS): Celenia tracks the students as they enter and take their FAMILIAR seats. One by one they pass until her target, Travis Noble (14yrs, long hair) enters the room.

ANGLE ON: Travis doesn't notice Celenia in his seat. He is oblivious to the world. He turns down the last column and makes his way towards the corner seat. Travis stops, in shock, at his cousin sitting in his seat.

TRAVIS

You're in my seat

CELENIA

(confidently)

I know. It's not quite as good as mine from the center, but I can get used to it. At-least it'll work for the day. I want a different view so here I sit. Plus, it's not like your name is not on it.

TRAVIS

Actually it is. It's the writing on the corner.

Travis points to the desk corner.

IMAGE: Doodling on the desk that spells TRAVIS.

ANGLE ON: Travis crosses his arms. He stares at Alicia.

TRAVIS (CONT'D)
I got two days detention for it.
But I'm proud of my work.

CELENIA
You did spell your name right.
Something to be proud of. I'm not
moving.

TRAVIS NOBLE
Yep --

ANGLE MID: Travis lifts his bag, WATCH shown on wrist, then moves to the empty seat to Celenia's RIGHT SIDE. Travis sits in the seat with a SMILE. The smile fades as he realizes the desk is a THREE-LEGGED MONSTER. It wobbles with each move. It tilts with each breath.

IMAGE: The chair legs touch the ground in three spots.

ANGLE ON: Celenia on the right. Travis on the left.

CELENIA
Imagine if every day someone sat in
a different seat. It would be
chaos, anarchy. Don't you think.

TRAVIS
I think I want my seat back. Your
trick can end, you won. I'll tell
everyone at the family reunion that
you bested me.

CELENIA
I'll trade the seat for your watch.

TRAVIS
(moving his watch)
You take my seat. Now my watch?

CELENIA
I didn't take your watch. I'm
asking for it. Politely.
Technically, you could have sat on
the ground. It's not like either of
us are going to pay attention on
the last day.

CELENIA (CONT'D)
You know cousin --

MRS. EUCLID (O.S.)

Class!

ANGLE ON: MRS. EUCLID (60s) checks the table with her organized construction paper. She turns on the projector which shows ORIGAMI on the DRY ERASE BOARD.

Mrs. Euclid beckons from behind the table of papers.

MRS. EUCLID (CONT'D)

I know it's the last day of class
and you're all excited about being
able to leave for the Summer. So am
I. I have a fun activity for us
today. We are going to learn about
origami.

ANGLE ON (OTS): Celenia notices the ticks and twitches of each student as the presentation begins to unfold. Nick Leroy in the first row is moving his leg so much that his desk is rocking. Billy Jean is pulling food from his pocket, a small packet of fruit snacks that will cause a loud crinkling when the plastic wrapping is torn in two.

MRS. EUCLID (CONT'D)

Has anyone ever heard of origami
before?

(pause)

Origami is a unique form of
manipulating paper to create
objects. You can create a paper
football, frog or even a swan.

ANGLE ON: Celenia and Travis turn to one another and feel the others pain. The lecture continues.

IMAGES: CLOCK unnaturally moves slowly.

CELENIA (O.S.)

Slowest minutes in history.

CUT TO:

INT. ROSSMOYNE SCHOOL HISTORY - CONTINUOUS

ANGLE ON (OTS): Alicia is on the edge of her seat as is most of the class.

CLOSE ON: The presenters are Chad and Jeremy. The lights shut off. Chad holds up a remote controller and his PERSONAL SPOTLIGHT shines on himself.

ANGLE ON: Chad smiles as Jeremy's face shows FEAR.

CHAD

Has anyone ever been to the North Pole?

(pausing)

Good. Cause now you'll all get to explore the North Pole with me. I know, I know, you're asking yourself if you can trust me to guide you through the blinding snow, sub-zero temperatures, (unnaturally long pause)

You can count on me to steer you right or left when necessary. With my partner Jeremy, we are going to assist you in learning about the explorer Samuel Clemens and Saint Nicholas, aka. Santa Claus.

CLOSE ON: Jeremy is in shock at the sound of SANTA CLAUS coming to the presentation.

JEREMY

I thought we were going with Mark Twain and Samuel Clemens. The writer.

ANGLE ON: Jeremy stares at Chad.

CHAD

I'm keepin' it interesting. Samuel Clemens and Santa Claus, not much difference except the reindeer.

ANGLE ON: Ms. Caripol leans back in her seat, smiles a 10.

MS. CARIPOL

Well have at it men. How great it is to ring out the school year with Christmas in June.

ANGLE ON: Alicia slides a little further into her seat as the train wreck continues. She glances out the windows.

IMAGE: SOAP LETTERS to see trees with TOILET PAPER flowing in the wind.

ANGLE ON (OTS): Alicia glares at the presented. A picture of MARK TWAIN is on the left with Saint Nicholas on the right of the presentation board.

ALICIA (V.O.)

What do I do when I catch them? I don't have a jail to hold them or a plank to make them walk. This being a cop, judge and jury thing is getting trickier. I guess it'll only matter if I know their names.

CLOSE ON: Chad with a SANTA hat and Jeremy with tears.

CHAD

Mark Twain and Saint Nicholas were practically brothers.

CUT TO:

INT. ROSSMOYNE SCHOOL HALLWAY - CONTINUOUS

ANGLE ON: STUDENTS make their way towards the EXIT. No chaos. No pushing for position. It's a perfect flow of traffic with students obeying the rules of the road.

CLOSE ON: Celenia and Marianne are together. They join Alicia as she makes her way forward.

CELENIA

It's over. About time because I've got places to go and people to see.

MARIANNE

No you don't. You're spending Summer at home in the air conditioning. Just like me.

CELENIA

Yes and I will enjoy every minute of it! Though my last class was pretty fun. Mrs. Euclid let us make origami which is actually a lot of fun. I made two frogs that can hop across my desk. And I got a new watch.

CLOSE ON: Celenia holds up Travis's WATCH.

ANGLE ON: Celenia turns to Alicia.

CELENIA (CONT'D)

Travis wants it back by next week. I confirmed he'll be at the game on Saturday. So I figure you'd see him then. I did tell him you would have the watch --

ALICIA
Thanks. I'll get it to him.

Celenia turns over the watch.

CLOSE ON: Alicia who puts in on her wrist.

ANGLE ON: They continue forward passing teachers who are just as eager to get on their way. They near the EXIT, the loud speakers turn on and Mr. Yeager voice starts to sing.
Hallelujah.

ALICIA (V.O.)
The man is true to his word. Look at us now. No pushing or pulling. Its military precision. This will only happen on the last day of school when everyone wants to get the heck out of here.

ANGLE ON (OTS): Alicia exits the school to enter the sunlight.

CUT TO:

INT. AVERYS DINNING ROOM - AFTERNOON

IMAGE CUT: The house is DECKED for a party like an indoor BASEBALL RALLY. Balloons of BASEBALLS float in the air. The tables clothes are stadiums. There old pictures on easels throughout the house. The kitchen is ready with TEAM CAPS for food. Alicia is standing at the threshold of the kitchen and dining room.

ANGLE ON: Rachel holds up GREEN STREAMERS in each hand.

RACHEL
How do you want to do this? The rooms are a little bigger than I thought.

ALICIA
I don't know. Streamers above the windows and around the door. One chair for the birthday boy next to the fireplace. Can I call him a boy?

CLOSE ON: Rachel moves a chair to the window, with tape in her mouth.

She steps up on the chair and starts to tape the STREAMER.

RACHEL

He's over seventy years older than you, why not. Probably take it as a complement --

RACHEL (CONT'D)

It'll remind him of his younger years. How's this Alicia?

ANGLE UP: Alicia examines the streamers, straight, even. She takes her time as Rachel's ARMS grow TIRED.

RACHEL (CONT'D)

Thoughts?

ALICIA

It's good, but we need a little more umph. A bit more birthday! Let me see what we still got on the table.

Alicia walks towards the table of decorations.

CLOSE ON: A second package of green streamers, party poppers line the back of the table like fire-crackers setup for a Fourth of July celebration. Specially designed napkins and plates list a timeline of events since Ricky was born.

ALICIA (CONT'D)

Mom, why does Ricky like baseball so much?

ANGLE ON: Rachel dismounts the chair to join Alicia.

RACHEL

Just something he grew up with.

Alicia offers party poppers in one hand. Rachel grabs them then moves to the corner of the room.

RACHEL (CONT'D)

He says some of the best times of his life were on the baseball diamond. I prefer Summer break. Which -

(glancing back at Alicia)

If you don't keep your grades up, you could be in Summer school.

CLOSE ON: Alicia shakes her head emphatically 'no' -

ALICIA

No, no. Never going do that. I
worked hard all year for the
Summer. I've earned this.

ANGLE ON: Alicia grabs streamers. She follows Rachel to the
corner. POP! The ladies stop to peer into the living room.

CLOSE ON: Remnants of a BASEBALL balloon is on the
countertop.

ANGLE ON: Rachel stares at a second balloon moving towards
the living room fan.

RACHEL

We should have turned the fan off.

ALICIA

There's still time before it
happens again.

RACHEL

Yeah ... I kind of want to see this
through..

ANGLE ON: Rachel tapes the Party Poppers to the corner wall.
Alicia preps for the STREAMER. Rachel tapes, then they move
to the other-side. IT just FITS.

RACHEL (CONT'D)

Might be as exciting as the game
tonight. I don't know how Mason is
going to do after the rain out.

ALICIA

When we got their half the team was
sleeping in the bleachers. At-least
they will be rested for the game.

CLOSE ON: Rachel smirks at Alicia

RACHEL

One to talk. How long are you going
to stay awake?

Alicia objects without words to the implication.

CUT TO:

EXT. BALL FIELD OUTFIELD - EVENING

The field LIGHTS are on. The scoreboard is lite up. The bleachers are FULL. The field is full of players with a RUNNER on 1st and a BATTER at the plate.

ANGLE ON: Behind the outfield fence, just past the BLEACHERS, is Alicia laying in a lawn chair. She can touch the FENCE. She can glance at the score board. She relaxes in her seat, eyes closed.

ALICIA (V.O.)
I made it to the second batter.
Almost a new record for me.

She tilts her RED hat down towards her eyes. Her hands grab the first page of a BOOK as she glances at the WATCH on her wrist.

ALICIA (V.O.) (CONT'D)
Alright. Mr. Noble. Let's see who
helped you play a stupid game.

CUT TO:

INT. TRAVIS NOBLE'S HOUSE BEDROOM - EVENING

A standard TEEN BOYS BEDROOM with loft bed, computer and CLUTTER.

ANGLE ON: Travis sits in his computer chair while Michael kneels with his SATCHEL on the ground, filling the satchel with SOAP.

TRAVIS
Drinks, forks, toilet paper, and
soap.

MICHAEL
All accounted for. I wonder if it's
enough.

TRAVIS
(shrugging his shoulder)
We can make it work. It's kinda
late to get more.

CLOSE ON: Travis glances at his watch. **6:15 PM.**

TRAVIS (CONT'D)
When are they supposed to be here?

MICHAEL
Seven thirty.

ANGLE ON: Michael finishes stuffing the last of toilet paper.

MICHAEL (CONT'D)
It'll fit. Kind of like Tetris.

ALICIA (V.O.)
Only not even close to Tetris.

TRAVIS
That's a long time to wait. We
should've made it sooner.

Travis exhales the anxiety as he plays with the RUBIK cube on his desk. Michael takes a seat on a SPARE CHAIR.

MICHAEL
It'd still be light. We'd
definitely get caught. We wait till
dark. A few hours of work then
home.

ALICIA (V.O.)
You're still going get caught.
Handcuffs and taser all around.

CUT TO:

INT. AVERYS KITCHEN - EVENING

FADE IN: Kitchen is decked out for RICKY'S BASEBALL PARTY. Rachel and Alicia sit at the island. Aside the baseball hats is a glass of STRAWBERRY LEMONADE.

CLOSE ON: Alicia's hands grasp the GLASS and she takes a refreshing DRINK. She lowers the glass to her mother staring.

ANGLE ON:

Rachel picks up her SUB of HAM and PROVOLONE.

RACHEL
We almost lost you tonight. That
ball only missed you by a couple of
feet. Maybe you should start to pay
attention to the game? Might mean
something to your brother.

ALICIA
I've made it this far into the
season without watching a game.
(MORE)

ALICIA (CONT'D)
Why start with only the last one
left. Seems kinda low brow to
pretend that I care about this base
and ball game. It's really boring
to watch --

CLOSE ON: Before Rachel takes a bite to eat.

ALICIA (CONT'D)
-- if Mason wasn't playing, if Dad
wasn't coaching, would you ever
come to watch the base and ball
game? --

ANGLE ON: Rachel sets her sub down. A peaceful, silent stare
between the two. One SIP to match the other SIP.

RACHEL
Six months we've been planning this
party and decorations.

ALICIA
Topic change.

RACHEL
Organizing all the family to come
in on the same day was a nightmare.
People just don't have the time to
make the trip.
(humph)
So much time for one night.

ALICIA
(reluctantly)
How about Brian?

RACHEL
(laughing)
My brother is still upstate in jail
for two more years. Fool shouldn't
have tried to evade the lawman on
taxes. Worst move he could make.
Then there's Sarah, who figured out
how to be here, without being here.

Alicia finishes her drink.

RACHEL (CONT'D)
How about you head up?--

ANGLE ON: Alicia stand up.

RACHEL (CONT'D)
Don't stay up too late kiddo, big
day tomorrow.

Alicia turns to exit, stops, then turns back.

ALICIA
I'm in Summer mode. Sleeping all
morning and naps in the afternoon.
It's a rough life to live.

RACHEL
I can relate.

ALICIA
You might want to, but you'll work
a few weeks in the Summer at
school. Those Summer school kids
got it rough.

RACHEL
Your dad took Summer classes in
college and he turned out okay,
well, normal. Anyway, you need to
stop stalling and go to bed. I want
an easy morning.

Alicia senses the END and exits towards the hallway.

ALICIA
Good night mom.
(walking away)
You still didn't answer my question
about WATCHING THE GAME!

CLOSE ON: Rachel's hands grasp the frustration in her MIND.
She exhales the stress. She glances up.

RACHEL
Stalling! Bed time.

STOMPING is heard from the STEPS. Rachel sips the last of her
drink.

CUT TO:

INT. AVERYS UPSTAIRS HALLWAY - LATE AFTERNOON

ANGLE ON: Tumbling slightly from side to front, Rachel makes
her way out of her bedroom and down the hallway. The hallway
is CLEAN.

CLOSE ON: Rachel maneuvers down the stairs to sound of PEACE. Turning at the bottom of the steps.

ANGLE ON: The morning sun reveals a clean kitchen.

CLOSE ON: Rachel opens the freezer door and peers down at the cake.

IMAGE: Top of cake is a picture of ROLLIE FINGERS and a CURLY MUSTACHE that makes two full loops around each side of his mouth.

BANG! BANG! BANG!

ANGLE ON: Rachel's eyes close. She leans back, closes the freezer door. She slowly walks towards the BASEMENT DOOR. She listens.

RACHEL
Patrick! Get up here now!

CLOSE ON: Rachel waits with CROSSED ARMS for her son to exit the BASEMENT.

ANGLE ON: Patrick exits like a ZOMBIE with black circles around his blood-shot eyes. Patrick yawns.

RACHEL (CONT'D)
Would you like to explain to me
what you're doing?

CLOSE ON: Patrick shakes his head 'no' --

RACHEL (CONT'D)
It's opposite morning. That means
yes. Explain?

PATRICK
Ugg. I want to play the game before
someone else wants the TV. I got up
at six.

RACHEL
It's Saturday ... in the Summer.
Try sleeping in. It's what the rest
of us do. Go wake your brother and
sister up. I want everything to be
set for tonight. Go!

ANGLE ON: Patrick nods 'yes' then shuffles across the floor, out the kitchen and towards the stairs.

CLOSE ON: Patrick's electric SLIDE across each step doubles the time to get the job done.

CUT TO:

INT. AVERYS MASON'S ROOM - CONTINUOUS

ANGLE ON: Patrick throws a PILLOW that misses MASON. The pillow hits the LAMP.

CLOSE ON: Mason's eyes open with Patrick staring above him.

PATRICK

Mom says you need to get up. If you don't get up, then mom's going to make you do something.

ANGLE ON: Mason pulls the sheet over his head. No words in response. Patrick shrugs his shoulders and leaves the room.

CUT TO:

INT. AVERYS ALICIA BEDROOM - CONTINUOUS

ANGLE ON: Patrick TIP-TOES towards the occupied bed. He has a NERF GUN in his hand. He stops. The occupant is a fake - a BODY PILLOW.

CLOSE ON: The POINT of TOOTHBRUSH impacts his back.

ALICIA (O.S.)

Ha!

PATRICK

You weren't downstairs and I cleared the room.

ALICIA

Why are you in my room?

PATRICK

Mom wants everyone up because of the party. My job is to wake you up. Since you are up then my job is done.

ANGLE ON: Patrick spins around to see his sister brushing her teeth. His hand air circles her face.

PATRICK (CONT'D)

Ya, know. Your face may stay that way, oozing toothpaste and all.

ANGLE ON: Alicia dismisses the brother as he exits the room. She continues to brush as she makes her way to the FAMILY TREE on the wall.

IMAGE CUT: Pocket knife, buttons, marbles, tin container, coins, and TRAVIS'S WATCH.

ALICIA

Time for one more trip before the party. One more skip back to the good old days.

CUT TO:

EXT. AVERYS - ACRES TREEHOUSE - HIGH NOON

CLOSE ON: Alicia lays down on the FLOOR. She scans her items: a marble. A tin (fading green, two worn strips, B-owman in gray on its side). A pocketknife. A watch.

ALICIA

So many options with so little time.

ANGLE ON: Alicia leans up to scan the acres. The wind is gently blowing, the sky is partly cloudy and the deck is setup with tied down balloons and a large FIREMAN GRILLING STATION.

ALICIA (CONT'D)

I know what I want to do, but I don't have the time for that.

CLOSE ON: Alicia closes her eyes and grabs the TIN.

ALICIA (V.O.)

No internal conversations that are solely meant to delay my trip back to the past. Just like this inner monologue is doing. It's Mudville or Bust!

Alicia closes her eyes.

CUT TO:

EXT. AVERYS SANDLOT - 1940 - AFTERNOON

ANGLE ON: A batter in 40s gear gets ready for a throw from DAVEY (16yrs, pitcher). He starts his WIND-UP for a PITCH.

ALICIA (V.O.)
 Alright Ricky. Time to learn a bit
 about your growing up in the 1940s.
 Hope you're not one of them Soda
 Jerks.

CLOSE ON: Ricky (15yrs, batter) ducks out of the way of the
 BASEBALL.

ALICIA (V.O.) (CONT'D)
 Hey! I don't ever want a ball
 thrown that close to me ever again.

WHISTLING in the BACKGROUND.

EXT. AVERYS ACRES - 1940 - AFTERNOON

ANGLE ON: Davey bolts past Ricky as the SANDLOT is in the
 background.

ANGLE ON (OTS): Ricky sees Davey take the lead. In the
 distance is a picnic table. He gives chase as the two run
 towards the table.

CUT TO:

EXT. AVERYS SANDLOT PICNIC TABLE - 1940 - AFTERNOON

A table set for THANKSGIVING DINNER the Summer. A turkey with
 gravy. A set of corn on the cob.

CLOSE ON: Davey's hand reaches for the corn.

GRAM (O.S.)
 Hands off!

ANGLE ON: Davey pauses as he turns to see GRAM (60s, gray
 hair, anxious). Gram smiles.

GRAM (CONT'D)
 Palms?

CLOSE ON: Davey shows his hands for INSPECTION by the
 matriarch.

CLOSE ON: Gram examines Davey's hand then Ricky's hand which
 are presented for review.

RICKY
 I got them almost clean.
 (taking a seat)
 (MORE)

RICKY (CONT'D)
I spit so much into my hands, that
my mouth is dry.
(with mouth open)
See. No spit. Dry.

ANGLE ON: Davey laughs at his brother. Davey takes his seat
as Gram glares at Ricky.

GRAM
I can tell who's your dad. I
should've corrected your father
more. You boys got it easy.

DAVEY
I know Gram. Most people ain't got
you for a Gram.

GRAM
(not impressed)
Kissing up ain't going to get you
food till you rinse those mitts of
yours.

Davey and Ricky stare at each other.

RICKY
I need spit.

ALICIA (V.O.)
Oh, disgusting. This is a horrible
trip.

CLOSE ON: ELANE AVERYS (30s) elegantly takes her seat. MR.
AVERYS (30s) takes his seat aside his wife.

ANGLE ON: Mr. Averys looks at his boys.

MR. AVERYS
You giving Gram problems.

GRAM
I know who they learned it from.

ELANE AVERYS
Leroy will be here in a bit. He is
finishing up the firewood.

RICKY
I'll be doing that when he's gone
right. Swing the ax.
(flexing muscles)
I can do it better than Leroy.
Younger. Stronger. Better.

CLOSE ON: Gram leans back, still not impressed.

GRAM
Ain't better at washing those
hands.

An eerie silence is CAST over the picnic table. The
chattering lessens. The glares go from one another to
anything else. A soft exhale from Elane.

ANGLE ON (OTS): Gram SMILES as she notices LEROY (18 yrs)
walking up towards the table. Leroy walks past Elane and
gives Gram a hug.

GRAM (CONT'D)
Glad you came.

CLOSE ON: Leroy presents his palms for inspection.

RICKY
(interrupting)
When do you ship out?

ANGLE ON: Ricky asks in sincerity without reading the TABLE.

CLOSE ON: Leroy smiles then chuckles at the question.

LEROY
It's fine.
(glancing at Elane)
Ricky is getting it out of the way.
Before we eat, I've something for
both of us.

ANGLE ON: Leroy takes a seat between Ricky and Davey. He
searches his shirt pocket - NOTHING. He reaches down at his
duffle bag.

CLOSE ON: Leroy pulls out a TIN CAN with BOWMAN on it and a
silver POCKET WATCH. Ricky and Davey are FIXATED on the
items.

ALICIA (V.O.)
-- One of them looks familiar. Tin
is definitely something that I've
seen before, might have in my hand.
The other, hmmm. I've never seen
that watch before now --

ANGLE ON: Davey accepts the WATCH, wraps it around his wrist
and shows it off to the crowd. Leroy turns to Ricky who is
waiting, impatiently for the tin.

LEROY

This is what I want you to take care of while I'm gone. I know it looks like an empty tin box, that's because it is.

(pausing for response)

I ain't that mean Ricky, I put Joe DiMaggio in the box. Figure he'd make it look better.

CLOSE ON: Leroy OPENS the tin. Ricky peers cautiously into the tin. At the bottom is a mint condition 1939 Goudey Joe DiMaggio rookie card. Ricky's eyes glance up.

MR. AVERYS (O.S.)

He fit in that little thing! Dang!

ALICIA (V.O.)

You can stop Mr. Averys. No one is laughing for a reason. It is good to know who is on the card, it's so ruined, I couldn't tell.

ANGLE ON: Ricky takes the TIN, carefully lays it on the table. Ricky tries to unbutton his shirt pocket. He fails multiple times, then a SUCCESS.

ALICIA (V.O.) (CONT'D)

-- It shouldn't take so much effort to open a pocket.

ANGLE ON: Ricky pauses before he takes the CARD out of his pocket to hear Leroy.

LEROY

Now when I come back, I want both of these back. I'm not giving it to you or selling it to you.

RICKY

You'll get it back looking just as good as what you gave me. Not certain about the watch though, Davey is a bit of a mess.

DAVEY

One to talk --

RICKY

Two to tango

ALICIA (V.O.)

So lame fellas. So bad.

ANGLE ON: Gram CLEARS her throat which SILENCES the table.
Ricky pulls out the TY COBB CARD from his pocket.

RICKY
Ty met Joe. He's going to be your
bunk mate for a while, at least
till Leroy comes back.

CLOSE ON: Ricky lays the Ty Cobb card on top of Joe DiMaggio.

CUT TO BLACK.

EXT. AVERYS - ACRES TREEHOUSE - AFTERNOON

Alicia wakes up in the TREEHOUSE. She turns to her side to
see the SUN reflecting off Travis's WATCH. She focuses on the
moving minute hand. **5:15pm**

ALICIA
Quarter after five. People are here
in thirty minutes!

Alicia scrambles to her feet. She steps towards the stairs,
pauses, returns to get all her items.

CLOSE ON: Alicia puts them in her blanket, tosses the blanket
over her shoulder, then runs down the steps.

WIDE ON: Alicia runs from the treehouse, past the willow and
garden towards the house.

ALICIA (CONT'D)
Got to go. Got to go.

Alicia jumps over the deck stairs and onto the landing. A
quick sprint towards the SLIDING DOOR and she steps inside.

CUT TO:

INT. AVERYS DINNING ROOM - CONTINUOUS

Alicia steps inside. Rachel is setting the table and lanterns
HANG from the ceiling with tea cup candles.

ALICIA
Sorry mom! Why didn't you get me
up?

Rachel focuses on the finishing touches that NO ONE will
notice except herself --

RACHEL

I sent your brother, but he said
that he couldn't find you. He said
you probably ran off and joined
another family; that, you weren't
happy with this one--

Alicia's eyes grow wide and face red from anger.

ANGLE ON: Rachel smiles with a candle light in her hand.

RACHEL (CONT'D)

It was a joke dear. You fell asleep
in the treehouse again so I let you
go. Only spiders could hurt you
there.

ALICIA

That's not nice.

Alicia starts to exit the room.

RACHEL

Dad would say leaches.

Kyle is leaning at the THRESHOLD of the room.

KYLE

I would. Leaches that suck blood.
Snails that leave a trail of snot
behind them.

ALICIA (O.S.)

I'll need ten minutes for wrapping
the present. Five minutes to calm
down so I don't hit anyone and the
rest to get ready.

ANGLE ON (OTS): Kyle smiles at his wife who finishes the
table.

KYLE

Do you need help with the pretzels?

Rachel turns, with a smirk as she walks past her husband.

RACHEL

I wasn't waiting. They were done
three hours ago and taste amazing.
Plus you only want to help with
food so you can eat the food.

KYLE

Oh...

RACHEL
You have to wait.

Rachel exits the room while Kyle slyly makes his way to the table to taste test some HERSHEY'S KISSES.

CUT TO:

INT. AVERYS FOYER - MINUTES LATER

Do-Ray-Me-Fa-So-La-Te-Do!

CLOSE ON: Kyle closes one eye and peers into the peephole on the door.

IMAGE ON: A bubble figure of BRIANNE (30s, quirky) appears on the other side, waving her hand in the air.

ANGLE ON: Kyle pulls the door open and smiles as he sees his sister, Brianna, and brother-in-law, Ryan, at the stoop.

RYAN
Nice doorbell. Kinda feel like I
should be on an Austrian mountain
with seven kids.

Brianna steps inside the door. She gives Kyle her jacket.

BRIANNA
Better you than me. If you boys
want to roam the mountains with
seven kids, have at it. Rachel and
I will be living at a spa getting
massages every evening.

Brianna moves PAST her brother at the foyer. She turns the corner to the living room. A ROAR from the CROWD (8 adults, 12 children) crescendo then FALTER at the realization of Brianna ENTERING the room.

BRIANNA (CONT'D)
The party is now here! Sorry we're
a bit late. There was an accident.

Brianna SCANS her audience, PEERING at faces she hasn't seen in years. She STOPS at a gaunt man sitting in-front of the window. RICKY (80s, old) is SNICKERING at the sight and SOUNDS of everyone.

BRIANNA (CONT'D)
If I hug you too hard, will I break
a rib?

RICKY

I think your cousin already did.

Ricky laughs at his own words and smiles at the attention.

BRIANNA

How's it feel to be a young
whipper-snapper like the rest of
us?

A CHILD grabs Brianna's leg, causing her to be off balance.

RICKY

I ain't been that since, wow.
(pausing)
Since the 40s.

Brianna moves with a CHILD on her LEG towards an open SEAT.

BRIANNA

When you walked three miles to
school in a blizzard.

RICKY

That was never me. I'd skip school
and stay in bed. My brother, what's
his name, was the book worm.

Ricky takes in the scene of everyone getting set and
comfortable.

CUT TO:

INT. AVERYS LIVINGROOM - MOMENTS LATER

A sympathetic response comes across as the picture projects
across the wall. Ricky as a child losing a battle with a
garden hose.

KYLE (O.S.)

When was that Ricky?

RICKY

I don't remember one.

Projector image of Ricky, Leroy and Davey. The three stand
proud in-front of the willow tree in the backyard.

RICKY (CONT'D)

(sad)
I don't remember that one.

CLOSE ON: Angst on Brianna and Ryan's face.

ANGLE ON: The sea of children PART more effectively than MOSES separating the Sea. The children follow the cake that is just ABOVE eye level in RACHEL'S HANDS. Rachel sets the cake on the table aside Ricky.

RICKY (CONT'D)
The stache looked funnier in
person.

Rachel leans forward, lights the SINGLE CANDLE then backs up to let everyone have a clear view of the BIRTHDAY BOY. The CROWD sings **Happy Birthday** in an UNREHEARSED rendition that amplifies that they are all TONE DEAF. A round of APPLAUSE.

BRIANNA
If we're racing to a hundred, you'd
be in the lead Uncle Ricky!

RACHEL
Kyle, can you get the gifts for
Ricky while I cut the cake into
pieces?

Rachel takes the cake back through the PARTED Children. At the threshold of the kitchen is Patrick.

PATRICK
Can I help. I'll be good.

BRIANNA
That sounds like a lie. Perhaps I
should help you. Two women can get
the job done.

Rachel turns and smiles at Brianna.

RACHEL
I know you too well. You'd be worse
than the boy. You'd want to taste-
test each of the different flavors.

CLOSE ON: Kyle holds a CARD in one hand, a GIFT in the other.

KYLE
(to himself)
How about I switch between the two
piles.

Kyle grabs the pastel blue card. He slides open the envelope, then hands it to RICKY who reads the COVER.

CLOSE ON: Ricky old hands hold the card with a cover of a retirement community setting and elderly men and women with walkers, proclaims in vibrant purple **'To an old man like you from me...'**

He turns the page to witness the elderly men and women standing around a birthday cake in their swimsuits at a beach. The words on the inside page state **'Happy Birthday!!!. P.S. If you weren't blind before today, you will be after looking at this card. Best wishes.'** The SIGNATURE at the bottom of the page read: Brianna and Crew.

BRIANNA (O.S.)
(yells)
Happy Birthday Ricky! Thought you'd like the card.

ANGLE ON: Ricky looking from the card to the crowd. He sees Brianna give a THUMBS UP as she makes her way to the kitchen.

RICKY
I do!

Ricky smiles a smile that is rarely seen. He points to the gift with the NEWSPAPER WRAPPING. Kyle hands the GIFT to RICKY.

KYLE
Chicago Cubs lose the World Series!
Again!

As Ricky removes the newspaper. Alicia maneuvers through the children to stand ASIDE RICKY.

ALICIA
This one has a story.

Alicia waits as he finishes removing the wrapping to REVEAL a tin with a B-wman on the top. Ricky leans back and turns to Alicia.

RICKY
Story time Alicia.

Alicia exhales the stress and smiles.

ALICIA
Well
(scanning the room)
I was exploring in the acres last year like I do every year. I turned over a few stones from the farmhouse when found a bigger box with leather and a tin can inside.
(MORE)

ALICIA (CONT'D)

Dad noticed writing on the bottom,
'To Ricky. Keep them safe till I
get home. Leroy.

(glancing at Ricky)

I thought I'd give it back to you
on your birthday.

Alicia smiles at Ricky. Before she steps to leave, Ricky starts.

RICKY

I remember this.

(tears start to swell)

My brother gave this to me the day
before he left for World War II.

Leroy Russell Averys.

(clearing his throat)

He never came back home. He'd send
letters describing his ship, the
biggest thing he'd ever seen. Even
bigger than that skyscraper in
Harrisburg. The letters stopped. My
dad said Leroy died at the Battle
of Leyte Gulf. His ship had gotten
hit by an airplane. A direct
strike.

ALICIA (V.O.)

I didn't know any of this. I'm so
bad at this. Why did I even try
when failure was going to be the
outcome?

Alicia FREEZES not knowing to RUN AWAY or hide where she stands. Ricky clears his eyes.

RICKY

I had lost this. Heck, I didn't
even remember I had lost it till
now. It's got Ty Cobb and...

(opens the tin)

Joe DiMaggio. That man had a swing.
Me, Davey and Leroy used to play
stick at the sandlot in town.

Ricky works his way to a SMILE as he closes the tin. He nods to Alicia.

RICKY (CONT'D)

Thank you for the gift and bringing
back my memories. It appears I lost
them when I lost the tin. Give me a
hug.

Alicia leans down to give a gentle hug. Ricky whispers.

RICKY (CONT'D)
 Bringing back my memories is the
 best gift I could have gotten.
 Thank you.

Alicia FAKES a smile, then bee lines it towards the Kitchen.
 A child nearly falls over as she exits the now AWKWARD room.

CUT TO:

INT. AVERYS - KITCHEN - CONTINUOUS

The CAKE has been served into many of the BALL CAP CUPS.
 Rachel continues serving as Brianna is SUPERVISING the work.

RACHEL
 How's everything going?

Alicia ignores the question and searches for a seat. Once
 she's set, she lowers her shoulders.

ALICIA
 My gift made Ricky cry? I didn't
 mean it, just thought he'd like his
 tin can and cards back.

BRIANNA
 I'm sure it wasn't that bad. People
 cry over anything. I cried watching
 the movie Titanic.

RACHEL
 You didn't know the boat sank. Did
 you?

ALICIA
 --My gift reminds Ricky of his dead
 brother, Leroy.

Rachel and Brianna's face drop. SHOCK is the only response.

RACHEL
 Well, maybe if you bring him ice
 cream cake, he'll be a little
 happier.

Alicia gives her mother the DEATH STARE at the assertion that
 cake could overcome the bad memory. Rachel recognizes the
 look.

RACHEL (CONT'D)

This is the only time you'll get away with giving me that look little lady.

ALICIA

It's a dead brother, not an empty stomach. After he got the gift, he told me it was the best gift that he'd gotten. He's only had one card and gift so I'm thinking it was more being nice than being honest. Either way, I doubt cake will make it better.

PATRICK (O.S.)

It always makes my day better.

Rachel, Brianna and Alicia turn to see Patrick sitting in the corner with three BASEBALL CUPS of cake and ice cream.

PATRICK (CONT'D)

I could eat cake for breakfast, lunch, dinner and snack.

RACHEL

No! You can't!

Rachel turns back to Alicia.

RACHEL (CONT'D)

If Ricky says it's the best gift, then I wouldn't worry about anything. It probably just brought back old memories. Now. Before the children revolt --

Rachel hands Alicia and Brianna a BASEBALL CUP.

RACHEL (CONT'D)

Let's start serving the cake and ice cream.

Brianna lets Alicia go first towards the living room. They pass a GLUTEN named Patrick on the corner floor.

CUT TO:

EXT. BALL FIELD - BLEACHERS - AFTERNOON

SUN-GLARE. Alicia moves her SUNGLASSES down to see Baseball PLAYERS on the field.

Mason is on first base warming up by tossing BALL in the INFIELD. Patrick, Ricky and Rachel sit on the metal bleachers ONE STEP in-front of Alicia.

ALICIA
What period is it?

Patrick and Ricky turn in SHOCK to Alicia! Rachel sips her tea and shakes her head 'no.'

RICKY
Inning my dear. It's the bottom of the first inning.

PATRICK
Please don't tell anyone we're related.

Alicia shakes her head in agreement.

ALICIA
Never crossed my mind.
(laying down)
I'm going to sleep. Wake me up when the final quarter starts.

Patrick and Ricky stare at one another as Alicia fidgets with the WATCH on her wrist.

CUT TO:

INT. TRAVIS NOBLE'S HOUSE BEDROOM - EVENING

Michael tosses a roll of toilet paper in the AIR. He spins in the chair then takes a shot at the BASKETBALL HOOP. Bank shot. He picks up the roll and places it in the SATCHEL.

ALICIA (V.O.)
This silence makes me think your scheming.

Into View Travis turns towards his DESK.

TRAVIS
Do you really think this will work?

MICHAEL
Dad always says if you put your mind to something, you can make miracles. Though I doubt he meant it about what we are planning to do.

TRAVIS
No. We really don't want to see
your dad's reaction.

ALICIA (V.O.)
I want to see your dad's reaction.
I imagine a volcano blowing up
would be more subtle.

The boy's anxiety shows as they return to silence and fidget
with every object in reach.

ALICIA (V.O.) (CONT'D)
This is so awkward. SAY SOMETHING!

Travis checks his WATCH.

TRAVIS.
They were supposed to be here
fifteen minutes ago. Just like them
to be late.

Michael fakes lifting the SATCHEL to build muscle. Travis
pulls out his phone to text. Travis turns his phone on,
slides open the text message.

TRAVIS
I'm texting Mrs. President.

ALICIA (V.O.)
I can see what you are typing. Ahh,
you just misspelled your name.
There you go. Tra-vis No-ble. Send.
Good job. You earned a cookie.

TRAVIS
I hope they don't take ...

Beep! Beep! Beep!

CLOSE ON: Travis slides the phone to see the NEW TEXT.
Staring at the phone.

TRAVIS (CONT'D)
We're already here. You just can't
see us.

Travis's eye look UP to Michael.

MICHAEL
Well that's creepy. Maybe we leave
them behind.

Travis stands up and walks to the door. He opens the door and POPS his head into the hallway.

CUT TO:

INT. TRAVIS NOBLE'S HOUSE HALLWAY - CONTINUOUS

ANGLE ON (OTS): Travis leans his head to stare down the hallway. Daniel McKean (15 yr, portly boy) stands talking to Travis's MOTHER who is out of view.

ALICIA (V.O.)
Daniel McKean! You little brat! I
can't believe you.

Travis pulls his head back into his bedroom.

CUT TO:

INT. TRAVIS NOBLE'S HOUSE BEDROOM - CONTINUOUS

Travis glances at Michael who is looking up from the chair.

ALICIA (V.O.)
Get back out there Travis!

MICHAEL
What'd you see?

TRAVIS
They're down the hall. Talking with
mom.

Angle On: Travis pops his head out of the bedroom.

CUT TO:

INT. TRAVIS NOBLE'S HOUSE HALLWAY - CONTINUOUS

ANGLE ON (OTS): Travis stares at Daniel. He WAITS till eye contact is made then slowly moves back into the bedroom.

CUT TO:

INT. TRAVIS NOBLE'S HOUSE BEDROOM - CONTINUOUS

Travis slowly closes his bedroom door. He sits down in his chair as Michael maintains his position.

MICHAEL
Tic-toc. Tic-toc.

TRAVIS
Please stop.

MICHAEL
Tic-toc. Tic-toc.

ALICIA (V.O.)
Hit him with the purse!

The door quickly opens with Daniel barely stopping it from
HITTING the WALL.

DANIEL
Hey, hey! Here comes the one man
comedy show to lighten this
graveyard up. You there--

Daniel points to Michael

DANIEL (CONT'D)
Smile good sir, you nominated me as
the jester. I seconded the motion
and myself voted against it.

ALICIA (V.O.)
I can't believe I'm listening to
this! I'm getting dumber by the
second. Losing IQ points already.

Daniel takes a seat on the BED and grabs a nearby BASEBALL.
He spins the ball atop his finger.

DANIEL
We set a goal. Might not be a good
one, but it's our choice. Chipper
up, we've got drama to create.

Daniel puts his face within inches of Travis's face, bobbing
ever so slightly.

DANIEL (CONT'D)
Admit it, I'm making you laugh;
might be at me, but you're
laughing. I'm the greatest jester
and man in the world!

ALICIA (V.O.)
You're not that great kid.

ANGLE DOWN: Michael, Travis, and Daniel stare down into the Satchel. The SATCHEL is full of toilet paper, forks and soap. Daniel adds a few extra bars of white soap.

TRAVIS
(looking at Daniel)
What scent is that?

DANIEL
Mostly lemon grass and ginger. I
made my own mix.

MICHAEL
I think the president will be
pleased. Really opens up the lungs
and gets me ready to run.

The men continue to talk as Michael slides to the door, opens it and peeks down the hallway.

ALICIA (V.O.)
-- What's next, lavender and
lilacs. I may not have the ability,
but I'm kicking Daniel out of the
gifted program! Do you know how
much you ruined my day? Of course
not, you weren't at school on the
last day.

Michael turns back to the group.

MICHAEL
We might as well review the game
plan because I think she'll be
talking for a while. Not that it's
bad, we just got somewhere to go
and we have to be there tonight.

CUT TO:

EXT. ROSSMOYNE WINDOWS - NIGHT

CLOSE ON: A streak of white crosses the window, smudges
accent the start and end of the line. The light from the flag
pole gleams from the bottom of the window toward the upper
most corner.

INTO VIEW: Travis's reflection in the window. He steps back
and admires his cursive writing and subtle design features.

TRAVIS
My ode to you Mr. Edgar Allen Poe.
Quoth the Raven never more.

ALICIA (V.O.)

Oh my god. You vandalized the school with a story from Lit class! All this work to write 'Raven' on a FREAKING window. I figure a guy must have some brains to survive - OBVIOUSLY I was wrong! If I could leave your body to yell at you I would and eventually I will. Just got one more fool to learn about. One more name to know.

Travis turns and walks AWAY from his work towards Michael who is kneeling on the ground STICKING FORKS in the ground. Travis starts HUMMING to himself.

ALICIA (V.O.) (CONT'D)

Where are you going?

Michael turns to see Travis.

MICHAEL

Can you stop humming?

TRAVIS

(stops humming)

How do you like 'My Tall-Tell-Heart' and let's not forget my Raven.

(turns to his work)

It is a masterpiece.

Travis starts humming.

MICHAEL

Seriously, if you don't stop humming I'm going to jab my ear drums out with a fork.

TRAVIS

(turning his head)

We'll you've got enough of them. No one will notice if one fork is missing.

Michael returns to his artwork as Travis is taking in the scenery. Daniel is walking up to take a GANDER at all the work.

ALICIA (V.O.)

Let me guess, you two plus Daniel are the three stooges.

(MORE)

ALICIA (V.O.) (CONT'D)
 A comedy act that turns into a
 tragedy when you realize people
 aren't going to like your work.

TRAVIS
 (cynically)
 Personally, I think my designs are
 the best. Not to take anything away
 from your 'A', but Alicia won't
 know it's for her. Doubt you'll get
 the courage to let her know.

ALICIA (V.O.)
 Alicia! That's me.

MICHAEL
 Its better that way.

ALICIA (V.O.)
 Is it Michael? Better this way.
 Your way. Or my way. I've got a one
 track mind and your getting run six
 feet into the ground.

Daniel stares past Travis as a figure walks towards them on
 the sidewalk. With a silhouette that is cast up the tree
 trunks, it turns onto the grass and advances on their
 position.

DANIEL
 Mrs. President! How do- you do?

LIZ MCKEAN (15 yrs, girl, Daniel's sister). She walks up to
 the boys, sliding her phone on.

LIZ
 I got them all. Personally, I think
 you out did yourself with the
 windows around the mathematics
 hall. It'll make the number
 crunchers mad.

Liz turns on her camera, swiping the screen to display the
 library of photos.

LIZ (CONT'D)
 I was kinda worried that someone
 might see the flash of the camera.
 Did everyone get to see all the
 window dressing?

IMAGE SLIDE SHOW: a tree, dressed in white paper with a
squirrel staring at the camera, window **Spirits of the Dead**, a
 maze with **Enigma**, a picture of **The Coliseum**.

Liz presses her finger against the pause button for the slide show.

LIZ (CONT'D)
Here's my favorite.

The boys close in on the phone, peering over Liz's shoulder. Travis nods in 'agreement' while Michael and Daniel are confused.

MICHAEL
What is it?

LIZ
It's a giant head with the words
Dream written across the window
panes.

Michael is LOST. Travis is stepping up onto his IMAGINARY SOAP BOX to explain the divinity of his work.

TRAVIS
It's a Dream within a Dream. Mrs.
Altland assigned it last term. It's
the one where we questioned how
fantasy and reality can be the same
thing. But we don't really know if
we are currently in the real world
or a dream world.

LIZ
I'd like to be a world with
unicorns.

ALICIA (V.O.)
That would be awesome! I'd have a
stable full of them. Which actually
sounds kinda cruel.

DANIEL
Wonder if Ms. Altland will figure
it out?

All four VANDALS stand in awe at the thought that a teacher could figure out the window WRITINGS.

DANIEL (CONT'D)
Maybe we're just paranoid because
we have the key and know what
everything is.

Liz walks over to pick up the satchel from the ground.

LIZ

It's a little late now. Given how
slow Daniel walks that might take
all night.

The three pick up the remaining supplies. Keeping close to
the school, the foursome make the most of the shadows and
avoid the streetlights.

CUT TO:

EXT. BALL FIELD - BLEACHERS - AFTERNOON

CLOSE ON: Alicia snaps up from the aluminum bed. She notices
the game is still in play, the sun still blazing down, and
the scoreboard marks the top of the fifth inning.

ANGLE ON: Alicia stands with a wobble as the crowd cheers at
the strikeout to end the inning. Side stepping her way down
the bleachers, she narrowly misses Patrick. He stares with a
mouth full of ice cream and a smile.

TRACKING SHOT: Alicia dismounts the bleachers and makes HASTE
for the other baseline where she saw Travis.

ALICIA (V.O.)

Time to give Travis back more than
his watch!

TRACKING SHOT: Alicia walks through the wall ball players who
are running around and tossing the ball. She doesn't give
Michael a look.

ANGLE ON: A BATTER in the box connects with a pitch. The BALL
rockets up and back behind the cage.

UMPIRE

FOUL BALL!

ANGLE ON: A child covers his head for protection. Another
child stares into the air to see where the ball may land.

ALICIA

Looking up for something to fall
down isn't the best option, kid.

The SHOCKED child immediately looks DOWN.

TRACKING SHOT: Alicia continues to walk around the concession
stand, passing the SMOKE from the POP-UP GRILL.

ALICIA (V.O.)

I've got bigger fish to fry. I can tell the police on them all and they'll go to jail, maybe worse. I can't prove anything. No one knows that I can enter people's minds. If I tell someone what happened, they'll think I'm a liar or that I did it. Which is probably worse. Maybe, if I steal Liz's phone... Because that won't get me in trouble.

TRACKING SHOT: Rounding the corner of the building, brings Alicia into enemy territory. A sea of green- and yellow-colored shirts and hats. Alicia's light BLUE shirt garners stares from the OPPOSING CROWD.

ALICIA

(mumbling)

Go back to what you're doing.
Nothing to see here.

ANGLE ON: Travis sits at the top of the FULL bleachers. Alicia walks up the stairs, then skips up to the top of the bleachers. She makes eye contact with Travis then takes her seat.

ALICIA (CONT'D)

Hi Travis. Seems like you're enjoying the game.

(glancing at the game)

I haven't really paid attention, but I bet it's a good game. It's the championship and all.

TRAVIS

Yep.

ALICIA (V.O.)

Is that all you got, Yep!

CLOSE ON: Alicia's face is growing red with frustration. She relaxes then exhales.

ALICIA

I'm going to sit here while the next batter warms up. There's already one out you know. Two more and the innings are over.

TRAVIS

Yep.

ANGLE DOWN: Travis glances down to Alicia who he senses wants a conversation. He nods his head, then takes a seat.

TRAVIS (CONT'D)

So. What brings you to the other side of the field? Among the green-men and women. My cousin said you will give my watch back to me at the game.

ALICIA

I told her I'd give it back to you. I figured you would be at the game.

CLOSE ON: Alicia removes the WATCH and holds it up to Travis. Just before he takes his watch.

ALICIA (CONT'D)

You know Travis, I've been thinking about some things. Things I'd like to go over with you. So how'd your last day of school go.

TRAVIS

Fine. Boring. Yourself.

Travis turns towards the field.

ALICIA

Not too well. What'd you think of the vandalism? Heard everyone is looking for the people who did it. Wouldn't want to be them. If they get caught, wow, they'd go to jail. Or worse yet, they may have to repeat the entire year of classes. What do you think would be worse?

TRAVIS

(ignoring the question)
He's gonna make it! Run faster!

ALICIA

I took a little walk out of the auditorium, saw all the soap on the windows. It didn't make sense to me at all so I started talking to people. One after another, then a third person after the first. Wouldn't you know that a good friend of ours, an unnamed friend, says the windows outside the auditorium resemble 'The Raven' from Edgar Allen Poe.

Travis snaps his head in SHOCK towards Alicia.

TRAVIS
What friend?

ALICIA
You've got nothing to be afraid of,
I mean, you didn't - or did.
(laughing)
I do love Edgar Allen Poe. And of
course you, you love it enough to
write it in soap on the windows of
school.

Travis begins to bite his lower lip.

ALICIA (CONT'D)
If we're good enough friends for me
to return your watch, then your
secret is safe. I have no reason to
turn you in to the authorities, not
for an art project. Are we good?

Travis fights himself to smile. He leans back and pulls his
ball cap down over his eyes. Alicia gets up from her seat,
stretching out her arms to feel the freedom of success.

ALICIA (CONT'D)
Oh - and if you ever have another
thought like the one that ruined my
last day of school, I suggest you
let it pass right though. Have a
good day Mr. Travis Noble.

Alicia CONFIDENTLY STRIDES down the bleachers. She dismounts
the bleachers and makes her way towards and around the
concession stand. She notices two girls fail at a hand stand
aside the concession wall.

ALICIA (V.O.)
Almost had it kid. Green shirt -
not so much.

Alicia rounds the final corner which disrupts the WALL BALL
frenzy. A distracted person FREEZES as a TENNIS BALL zooms
close to her face. She searches for the culprit, stopping at
Chris who POINTS to ALAN who smirks.

ALICIA
You almost hit me in the face.

ALAN
Would have been made an
improvement.

Chris walks away.

ALICIA
I'm surprised you could reach that
comment without a ladder.

Alicia continues her walk and locks onto Michael who is
trying not to LAUGH.

ALICIA (CONT'D)
Mike. Can we talk?

JEERS and HOWLS from the crowd. Alicia and Michael move to
the side where everyone can SEE them but not HEAR them.

ALICIA (CONT'D)
I just need a minute

MICHAEL
Take five is you want.

Michael is unwittingly FLEXING his muscles. Alicia is set
like a pistol with crossed arms.

ALICIA
I heard you had fun at school on
Thursday night. You know, putting a
few hundred forks into the ground.
Travis with Poe and the toilet
paper.
(waiting for a response)
What's the 'A' stand for?

Michael shrugs his shoulders.

MICHAEL
How'd you --

ALICIA
How isn't important. Most people
don't like post-modern vandalism.
Police consider it a crime. You
should know that. Lots of people
know that. Enjoy the feeling.

Alicia steps away then stops and looks at Michael.

ALICIA (CONT'D)
What's the 'A' for?

MICHAEL
(sneering)
A - is for Art?

Alicia glances past Michael to peer at Alan.

ALICIA

Alan. Michael's face need an improvement. A tennis ball to face should do.

TRACKING SHOT: Alicia continues her walk towards the bleachers as the WALL BALL players start a new game. Alan stalks his new prey and Michael glares in bewilderment.

ALICIA (V.O.)

Now he has to worry about the cops showing up - tapping at his door like that raven. FRICKIN Travis. Now I'm thinking of Lit class in the SUMMER!

Alicia pauses as she passes the bleachers. She stares at her brother who is flailed out on the lower bench seat in pain.

ALICIA

Are you okay?

PATRICK

I ate my ice cream and your ice cream. Bit too much for my belly.

Alicia shakes her head in frustration. She steps up on the bleacher risers--

ALICIA

How's the game?

She looks for a response from Patrick, but hears her mother.

RACHEL (O.S.)

If you'd stay awake, sit in the stands and watch the game, then you wouldn't have to ask.

Alicia turns to her mother with a smile.

ALICIA

We talked about this. I don't want to start paying attention at the end of the season--

RACHEL

--If the other team doesn't score then we win and the game is over. You can watch your brother for that long.

Alicia turns towards the field, pointing at Mason on first.

ALICIA
LET'S GO! BRING IT HOME MASON!

CLOSE ON: Rachel lowers her head as Ricky SNICKERS. Alicia sits at the edge of her seat, continuing to cheer.

CLOSE ON: The ball hits the catcher's mit. It's a strike.

UMPIRE
Strike three!

ANGLE ON: Alicia leans back to see Ricky sitting with his tin to the side.

ALICIA (V.O.)
Ricky's happy with the tin. Travis
and Michael are paranoid about me
knowing, but don't know how I know.
This is good day for me.

ANGLE ON (OTS): The pitcher throws the fastball. The batter swings. POP! It's a line drive to the SECOND BASEMAN who CATCHES the ball. Royals celebrate the WIN as STAN charges the mound.

CUT TO:

INT. AVERYS LIVINGROOM - EVENING

Kyle and Rachel lay on the couch with Alicia laying overtop the chaise chair. Patrick stands at attention.

PATRICK
Can I play video games?

KYLE
Are you going to play them all
Summer?

PATRICK
(admittedly)
Yes. I suppose. Probably.

RACHEL
You got one hour for the weekend.

Patrick sprints away--

RACHEL (CONT'D)
That's only because you were good
tonight!

Rachel glances at the television which is the WEATHER CHANNEL.

RACHEL (CONT'D)

Can you put something else on dear?
I can't watch the weather for two
hours straight like you can. I
prefer entertainment.

KYLE

I guess we can watch something more
entertaining.

(changing channels)

Here's some entertainment. The
evening news.

Rachel snuggles down a little lower into the couch. A glance
to the chaise chair where Alicia is seen getting comfortable
as well.

ALICIA (V.O.)

If only someone could carry me to
my room, then turn on my
television, then change the
channels to ones that I want to
watch.

Kyle moves to the edge of his seat.

KYLE

Looks like something important--

RACHEL

--Doubt it and stop moving! You
don't know how to make a good
pillow, do you?

ANGLE ON: **Breaking News** flash across the television screen. A
NEWSREPORT (Kristin) is on the scene at the ROSSMOYNE SCHOOL.

KRISTIN

It appears that the fun of a few
students may be coming to an end.
Many of you know students showed up
for the last day of school with a
significant amount of vandalism on
and around the school. As you can
see behind me, there was toilet
paper thrown on most of the front
trees; soap, which has since been
washed off, was used on the
windowpanes.

(MORE)

KRISTIN (CONT'D)

And the vandals also used a few hundred forks to make an 'A' just to the side of the main doors. Speaking with the captain of the police department earlier in the day, he told me that the police did receive information about five youths who apparently were involved in the vandalism. I'm told that a parent of one of the children contacted authorities about the incident and not long after, pictures of the vandalism began to appear on social media. Due to their age, the captain isn't sharing any names, but I'm certain that if it's online, then most people who want to know will soon find out. I'm being told that with the parent's information, charges may be brought in juvenile court.

ANGLE ON: RACHEL IS ALMOST UNDER THE COVERS.

RACHEL

Why would you post that stuff online?

(looking at Kyle)

"That's like trying to play a game of hide-and-seek at night while wearing a glow-in-the-dark shirt. Might as well just surrender and walk into the police station.

KYLE

(laughing)

I had a glow in the dark shirt.

RACHEL

I know. I donated it to the shelter.

Alicia is staring at the ceiling.

ALICIA (V.O.)

Five! I wonder who the fifth person was for this rodeo. At-least they know it's not me that turned them in. It's better this way. Better that I not be involved. I've got my Summer to enjoy.

RACHEL

Alicia! I'm ten feet away. You
could respond to me when I'm
talking to you. Can you pass me the
blanket.

Alicia reaches behind her, grabs the blanket and tosses it to
Rachel.

ALICIA

Oh and mom, about the vandalism. I
heard who it was. Want to know?

CUT TO BLACK.

TEXT: THE END

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